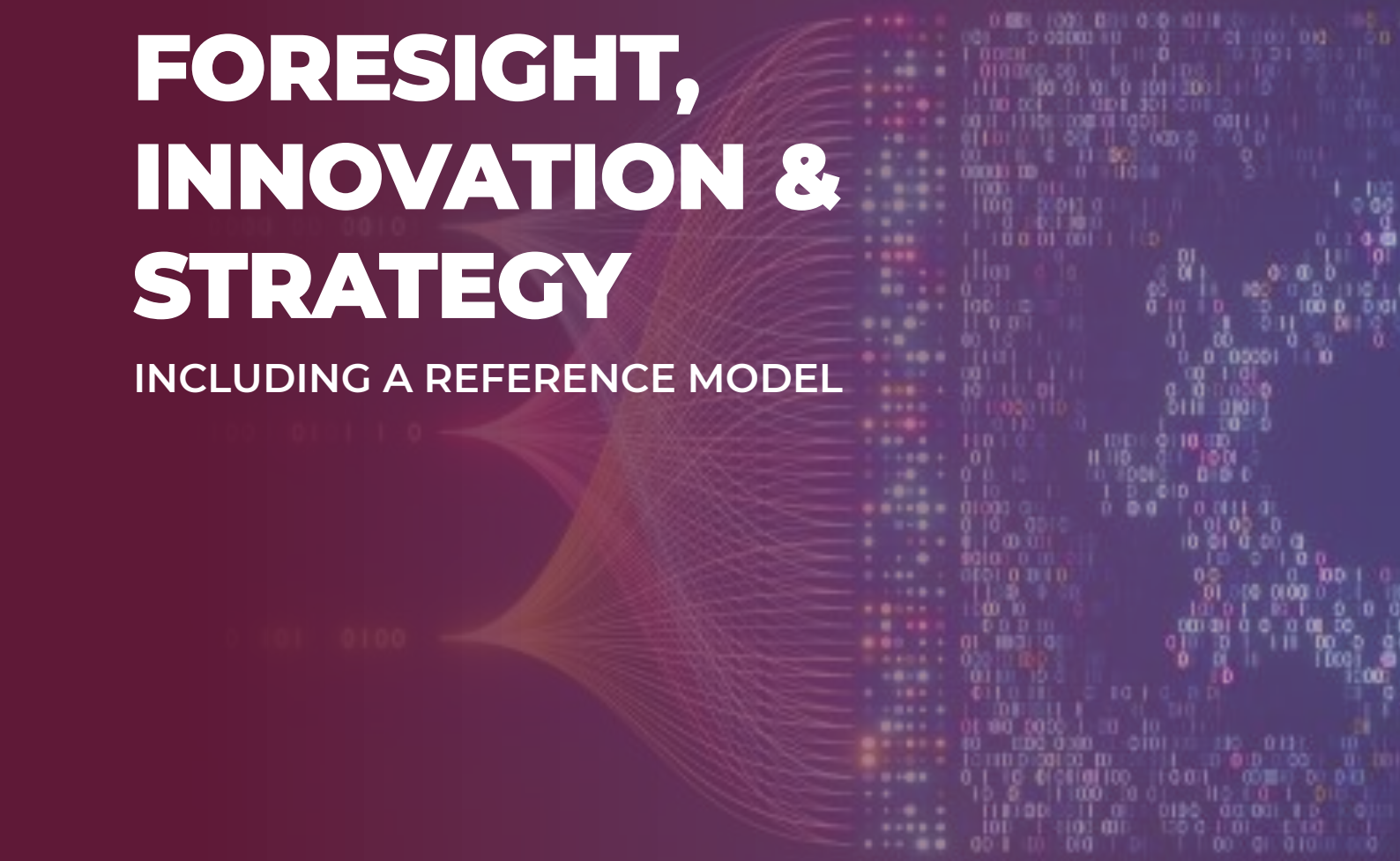
EDHEC

REPORT

GEN AI FOR FORESIGHT, INNOVATION & STRATEGY

INCLUDING A REFERENCE MODEL



20 OCTOBER 2026

UNLEASH TOMORROW

Foreword

At World Economic Forum's Global Foresight Network retreat in June 2026, we put a blunt question to the neuroscientist Prof. Henry Markram: **where will AI ultimately lead us?** His answer was disarmingly simple.

> *Either to unprecedented exceptionality or catastrophe.*

What stayed with us was the reason he gave. A human being who decides to commit to a future and bears its consequences. AI advises on correlation, fluently and tirelessly, at a scale no team can match, but it cannot feel the cost of being wrong.

By the end of six months of piloted AI across foresight, innovation and strategy methods as a Community of Practice, one of us put the same point in working terms:

> *AI is like a colleague that can at times generate amazing output, but may lack experience, context, and respond as if the answer has no consequence.*

What we found should reassure the anxious and calm the over-enthusiast in equal measure. AI is a powerful force multiplier. It widens our scanning scope, accelerates the synthesis of large data pools, and lets small teams perform analysis that once took many. But its capabilities are jagged. Some tasks are handled accurately and swiftly; on others that look much the same, it produces work that reads just as well but cannot be relied on. Efficiency then was not about maximising AI delegation, but human-AI workflow design.

We also came to appreciate the difficult yet crucial work of defining the division of labour between humans and AI and re-designing AI-human (or hybrid intelligence) workflows (Lim & Hwang, 2025). Judgement should be a human domain, we all agree, accountability for consequences is human, and all AI results should be considered draft until checked by humans. But as one participant noted:

> *I can think of no task more boring than checking AI output.*

In consequence, AI-enabled workflow needs more discipline and control than just calling on the help of a calculator. Discipline is built in three steps. Step 1 is a clear **intention**, not an underspecified and half-thought-through question. Step 2 is **careful planning of the analysis**, the needed depth, the appropriate method, data and a well-crafted prompt. If the first two steps have been well crafted, step three, result checking, should be the leanest step of the three.

None of us worked this out alone. The Community brought together strategy, innovation and foresight professionals from eight organisations, and our experiences with AI complemented one another. We shared where AI had paid off, learned from each other where it had not and why, and borrowed practices we had not yet tried. And as the models evolved several times during the six months, we could judge together which practices would hold across model generations.

> *Experimenting together improved the quality of everyone's experiments.*

It also stopped us from making costly mistakes, and it saved us from complacency. Each of us still had to find our own way, but none of us had to start from nothing. What we are left with is a working position on how to use it.

> *AI is just a tool. Organisations and individuals still need their own compass.*

This report is our attempt to give you a head start on both: where AI already earns its place, what it costs oversight, and where the practice still belongs to you. The road to exceptionality is making the AI follow your intention and your quality requirements. The road to catastrophe is easier to find and requires only cognitive laziness.

We thank every member of the Community for the work behind this report: for sharing earlier experience, for the difficult dissection of what prompts actually do, and for the honest comparison between our old human-led work and the hybrid-intelligence process we tested.

We hope that this report will take you on the path to exceptionality, better analysis and wiser decisions.

The EDHEC GenAI Community of Practice



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Executive Summary

Our Community of Practice set out to accelerate our learning on effective, ethical and safe AI use, understand the state of play, provide guidance on where AI already creates a strong return on investment and identify high-value use cases that integrate different methods. Three learnings stuck out.

Managing data quality is key

AI tools are trained on large amounts of data, some of it is high quality, but also includes data from unverified and biased sources and increasingly synthetic data. In the past no strategic analyst would go near such data, but today, with GenAI tools, they not only become part of the training data lake but may also be algorithmically amplified. Lufthansa Innovation Hub has established its own data collection system with a tiered data source qualification, a relational database and an agentic data queries engine. Going for selecting and governing your own unique data will become more important, not less. And more challenging as data volumes grow quickly.

Control your AI before it controls You

Model builders and platform providers are content to add a disclaimer that all results need to be checked by humans, but they leave open how. This is however in most cases neither convenient nor practical. In consequence, we can neither use AI as an “easy button”, i.e. prompting without thinking our request through, nor can we expect AI tools to naturally favour the most rigorous way of answering a prompt. Instead, we need to a) set an intention, b) control the analytic approach and manage the quality of the data and method that the AI tool applies and c) check the quality of the output. Here, frontloading, i.e. spending time on a) and b) will drastically reduce the time we need to spend on c), as we explain in Adopt a disciplined way of working with AI. To ensure a good collaboration with your AI tool that leads you to an effective hybrid intelligence workflow requires well-designed prompts. A good technique is to ask the AI tool to suggest a powerful prompt structure, which we refer to as a ‘master prompt’. We have included reusable prompts for every method we tested in our prompt library, available on request via this link. In addition, we also looked at the tension of calling on AI for speed and analysis muscle and the additional effort we need to spend to prompt and control the AI. The result is our overview on Assessing where GenAI use is recommended. That assessment also shows that control does not look the same across methods. In the analytical methods, AI increasingly leads while the human steers and checks. In the creative and value-defining methods, idea development and value proposition, the roles reverse. The human originates and owns the idea, and AI spars with it, challenging assumptions and searching for evidence for and against. Once the idea is human-owned, AI can again carry more of the work in concept development and business model design. With every model generation, this snapshot might need to be reviewed. The usage heatmap reflects 19 June 2026 and the recommendations reflect September 2026, but we believe that it already offers useful guidance on where to allocate our attention and development bandwidth.

Hybrid intelligence is a journey not a state

If we could map our ability to work hand-in-hand with AI on a scale from 0% to 100% efficiency, it is probably safe to assume that today we are all somewhere between these extremes. Many of us have already gained experience in prompting and feel the additional power they wield when using AI tools individually. Fewer of us have already experienced agentic AI use, and those who have might have felt the “jagged edge”, where some tasks "*are easily done by AI, while others, though seemingly similar in difficulty level, are outside the current capability of AI” (Dell’Acqua et al., 2026).* Even fewer would have experienced effective hybrid intelligence workflows across large teams. It is however the rethinking of how we work in Human-Human-AI configurations that holds the largest effectiveness potential. In small groups dedicating one person to be the Human-AI team that complements the human team can be a powerful setup. For advanced teams, having even multiple autonomous agents that take dedicated roles in a hybrid team might already lead to good results. It is ultimately about reconfiguring workflows to maximise hybrid intelligence effectiveness. In this report, we have already added a high-level human-AI workflow model to every method one-pager and also to our High Value Use Cases.

We conclude this first phase with the strong feeling that we have not reached a destination but embarked on a journey towards safe and effective hybrid intelligence. **Exchanging in the community helped and will continue to be a strong driver for continuous improvement.**

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Methods and our Reference Model

Why a reference model, and why now

Strategic foresight, innovation scouting, and exploratory strategy share a common burden. They require firms to look beyond what is immediately knowable, to entertain futures that do not yet exist, and to do so faster than competitors. For decades, these have been expert-led, resource-intensive activities, valuable but slow (Gordon et al., 2020; Rohrbeck et al., 2015).

Generative AI changes the economics. Tasks that once took weeks, such as structured literature scans, signal clustering, scenario drafting, and stakeholder mapping, can now be done in days or hours (Alon et al., 2025; Mühlroth, 2025; Toscani, 2026). A 2025 OECD and World Economic Forum survey of 167 foresight practitioners across 55 countries found that two-thirds already use AI in their work, predominantly for trend analysis, scenario development, and horizon scanning. Yet the same survey makes clear that adoption has outpaced method. Practitioners report unease about hallucinations, transparency, and inherited biases, and only a minority have any formal guidance for AI use (OECD, 2025).

The deeper issue is not speed but control. Many studies show the positive impact on pure analytic performance (Brandtner & Mates, 2021; Carayannis et al., 2025; Edwards et al., 2023), but the evidence on a positive impact on creativity and the ability to uncover new strategic options and new innovation fields remain mixed, suggesting that human-AI interaction remains important for success (Brem et al., 2023; Csaszar et al., 2024; Jiang et al., 2024). Our own pilots, and the longitudinal evidence from Siemens Professional Education's foresight process, where a fully human-led 2023 cycle was compared with an AI-augmented 2025 cycle, point to the same conclusion. AI integration does not produce uniform acceleration or automation. It delivers task-level efficiency gains and redistributes human effort, strengthening analytical breadth, structure, and completeness in scanning, consolidation, and drafting, while framing, prioritisation, contextual interpretation, legitimacy-building, and accountability remain firmly human-led (Rohrbeck et al., 2025). Capability is also jagged. Some tasks are handled well, while others, seemingly similar, degrade prior work. Used without discipline, GenAI generates plausible-looking material that can pass for foresight without being foresight (Dell'Acqua et al., 2026).

This is why a shared reference model matters now. Most organisations still use GenAI ad hoc, one analyst, one prompt, with little shared method and even less shared evidence about where it genuinely adds value. The result is duplicated effort, uneven quality, and a widening gap between teams that have learned to steer these tools and those that have not.

The objectives of the Community of Practice

The EDHEC GenAI Community of Practice was formed to close that gap collectively rather than firm by firm. Its five objectives are to:

- **Accelerate learning** on applying AI tools for foresight, innovation, strategy, and business exploration.
- **Assess the benefits** in quality, time, and resource usage.
- **Identify high-value use cases** where GenAI earns its place in the workflow.

- **Identify risks and boundary conditions** that mark the safe operating space for these tools.
- **Co-create a reference model** for ideal AI-augmented foresight workflows.

What this paper offers and how it is structured

This report, produced by the Community of Practice, is organised on three planes, shown in the figure below. At the base sits the **process documentation and prompt library**, the detailed workflow maps and tested prompts behind each method are available on request. The middle tier is the **methods one-pager**, a condensed, at-a-glance assessment on how GenAI performs in this method. The one-pagers also provide links to the output files of our pilot case. On the top plane, we provide **key lessons learned**, which includes our assessment of which methods are best suited to be supported by GenAI, which use cases receive the most value from GenAI integration and several tips and hacks.

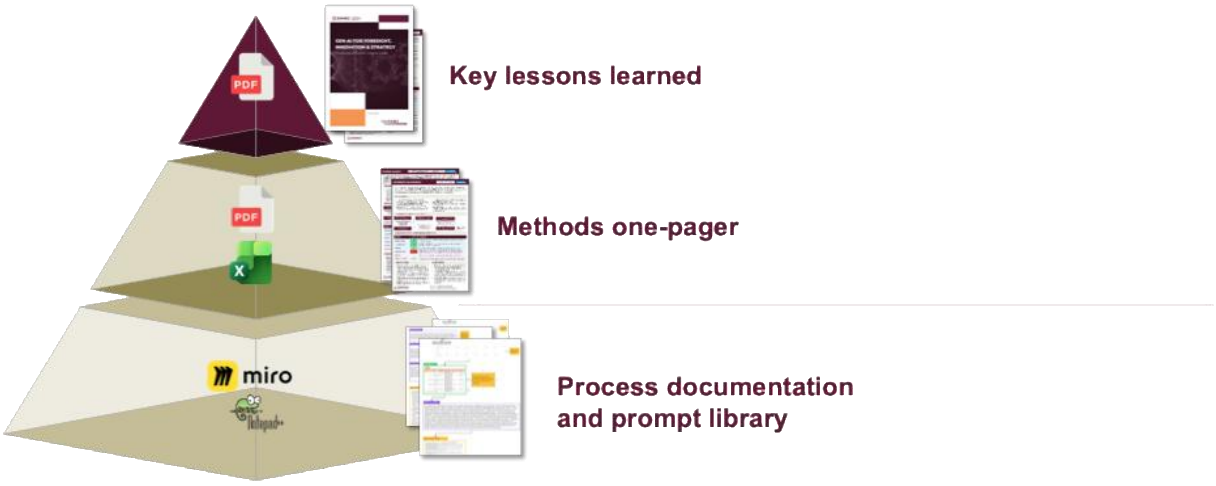


Figure 1: Report structure

The report aims to bridge the gap between model and practice and help anyone who would like to leverage GenAI. After this introduction, it presents the **reference model** and our assessment of foresight methods, including the 2x2 rating of where AI adds value and the amount of human oversight that is needed to deliver high-quality results. It then examines our **top 4 high-value use cases** in depth, from scenario narratives and videos to MACTOR actor analysis. A **Tips and Hacks** chapter distils five calls to action for any leader putting GenAI to work safely and at scale. The **conclusion** sets out what is now possible and what remains hard, followed by an **appendix** in which you find the method one-pager. The model is a starting point built on real practice rather than vendor claims. It is not a final answer, since the underlying technology is evolving fast, but it provides a solid baseline for applying GenAI professionally and effectively.

Rooted in our corporate foresight maturity model

The reference model did not start with GenAI. It is built on more than twenty years of foresight practice by the authors and on an established body of research into how foresight methods combine to support strategy and new business exploration. In particular, it draws on the integrated methodology of Heger & Rohrbeck (2012), which showed how complementary foresight methods, including use-case definition, value-network and MACTOR actor analysis, scenario analysis, and target costing, can be sequenced to explore a new business field while managing uncertainty and the interdependencies between its parts. That work established the methodological backbone onto which we map the contribution of GenAI.

The structure of the model follows the three core activities of corporate foresight set out in the 3P framework of Rohrbeck & Kum (2018) Perceiving, Prospecting, and Probing. *Perceiving* covers the practices a firm uses to identify the factors that drive change, scanning the environment and detecting weak signals ahead of competitors. *Prospecting* covers sense-making and strategising, working with analogies, scenarios, and systems thinking to interpret what those signals mean and to identify a superior course of action. *Probing* covers the move from analysis to experimental action, testing options, and translating insight into initiatives the organisation can commit to. Organising the model along these three activities keeps the focus on what foresight is for, rather than on any single tool or method.

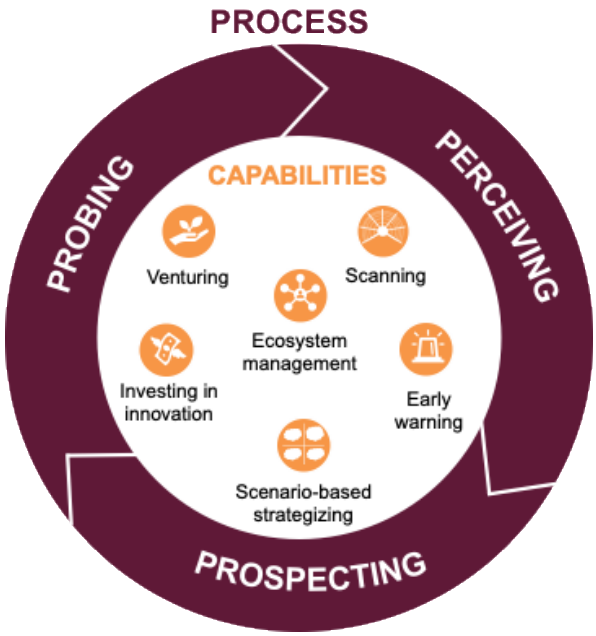


Figure 2: Corporate Foresight Maturity Model (Rohrbeck & Kum, 2018)

EDHEC Reference Model in detail

Within this structure, the model maps the generic foresight-driven business-exploration process onto a simple assessment of GenAI's contribution at each stage. In our Community of Practice, we assessed every method and phase, and recorded where AI adds value, where the picture is mixed, and where human judgment remains decisive.

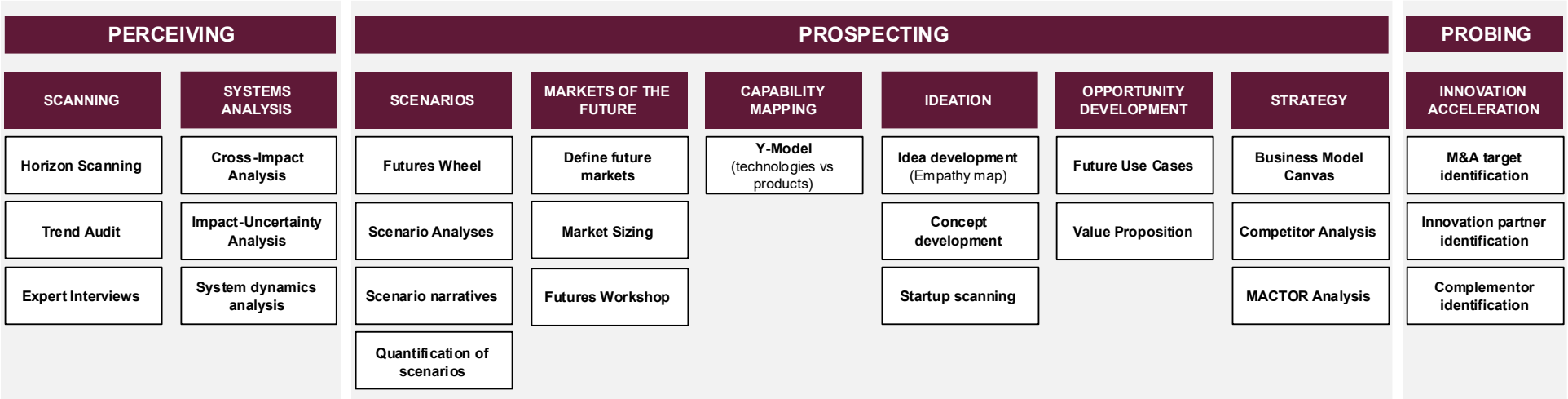


Figure 3: EDHEC Reference Model Strategic Foresight Methods

On the next page, we have mapped the level of usage of GenAI by our Community members on the date of our third workshop, 19 June 2026.

Community members heatmap - AI deployment as of 19 June 2026

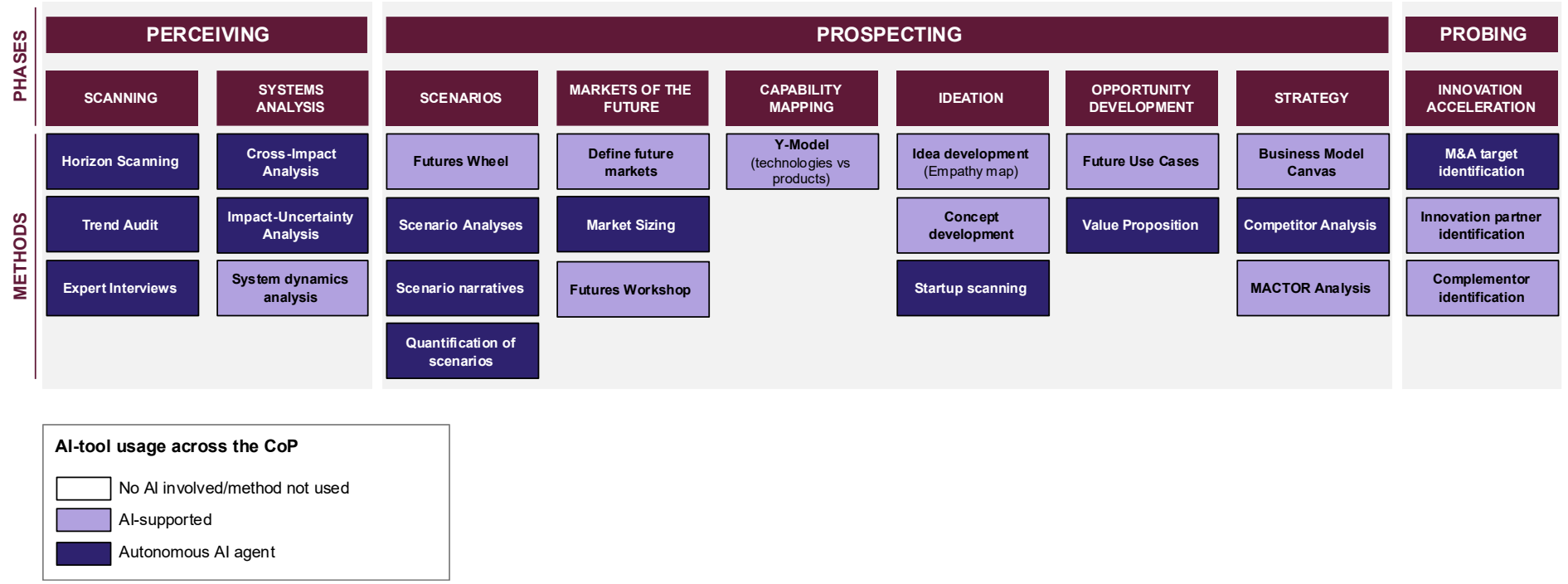


Figure 4: Heat map showing the AI usage by our Community of Practice members (19 June 2026)

Across the Community, adoption is already broad. At least one partner is using AI for every foresight method except business wargaming, and agentic workflows have been tested in the Scanning phase within the group. Usage concentrates most heavily in Horizon Scanning, Trend Audit, Scenario Narratives, Market Sizing, and Competitor Analysis, the methods where most of us now rely on AI. As one member put it:

> *It showed us what can be done that we are not doing yet*

Assessing where GenAI use is recommended

Not every method gains equally from AI. As one member summarised it:

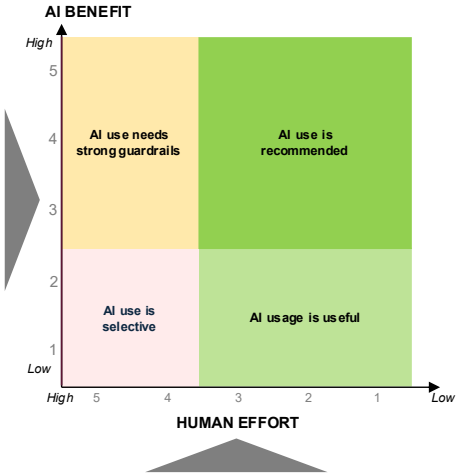
> *For some methods, AI can already be recommended. For others, the gains are often a trade-off with human effort.*

We assessed each of the twenty-five foresight methods on two dimensions that together determine whether GenAI integration is worthwhile. The **vertical axis** captures the benefit of using AI, the material gain in speed, and quality gain through data coverage and analytical rigour that AI brings to the method. The **horizontal axis** captures the human effort needed to achieve trustworthy, decision-ready output. This includes the cognitive effort of verifying AI output and the rework needed before it is decision-ready and shareable. Both are rated on a five-level scale anchored on the human baseline, as set out in Figure 5. Rating every method on both axes produces four quadrants, each carrying a different recommendation. Methods in the top-right, high benefit and low effort, are where AI use is recommended, because the material gains are achievable with lesser human effort. Methods in the top-left also deliver material benefits but demand higher human effort, so AI use needs strong guardrails, with structured review built in before outputs are usable. Methods in the bottom-right gain more modestly at low effort, so AI usage is useful to speed up the work. Methods in the bottom-left are where AI use is selective, only where the time invested in steering AI does not outweigh the benefit. As the recommendation snapshot is dated September 2026, the placements are expected to shift as models improve.

AI augmentation

Human baseline

AI BENEFIT = MIN (A,B)			
LEVEL	EFFICIENCY GAIN IN SPEED (A)	QUALITY GAIN (B) = MAX (B1,B2)	
		Data Coverage (B1)	Analytical Rigour (B2)
5	10x or more	**20x or more**; human couldn't realistically cover	**Beyond human**: Analysis humans wouldn't attempt
4	7x to < 10x	**10x to <20x**; substantially more needing several times the budget for human	**3 or more gains of**: evidenced, consistent, tested, triangulated, calibrated
3	5x to < 7x	**5x to <10x**; clearly more data points than human	**Systematic**: every item treated consistently and conclusions tested
2	2x to < 5x	**2x to <5x**; somewhat more than human	**Some additional checking**
1	< 2x	**Under 2x**; similar as human	**About the same as human**



Human baseline

AI augmentation

HUMAN EFFORT= MAX (C,D)		
LEVEL	COGNITIVE EFFORT (C)	HUMAN REWORK (D)
5	**Unverifiable**: too voluminous to follow or incomprehensible; errors can't be reliably found	**Redone**: 75% or more reworked
4	**Very hard**: Takes more time to review than accounted for. Errors are plausible and embedded in fluent reasoning	**Major rework**: 50% to <75% reworked; AI output serves as a skeleton draft
3	**Hard**: many assumptions need deliberate checking; sustained concentration needed to spot errors and inconsistencies	**Substantial revision**: 25% to <50% reworked; key parts restructured & context added
2	**Manageable**: followed in one pass with spot-checks; most errors visible on reading	**Targeted edits**: 10% to <25% reworked; passages corrected or contextualized
1	**Easy**: plain and complete at a glance; errors obvious	**Light edits**: under 10% reworked; ready after copy-editing

Figure 5: Rubric for assessing AI benefit and Human effort for GenAI usage



Figure 6: Assessment matrix to determine for which methods GenAI usage is recommended, today (Sept 2026)

These ratings translate directly into the reference model heatmap, which is shown on the next page. The colour coding carries the recommendation from the 2x2 into the workflow view. Dark green marks the top-right quadrant (AI use is recommended), light green the bottom-right (AI use is useful), pale yellow the top-left (AI use needs strong guardrails), and pink the bottom-left (AI use is selective). See the method one-pagers in the appendix for more details.

Foresight Methods and where AI usage is recommended

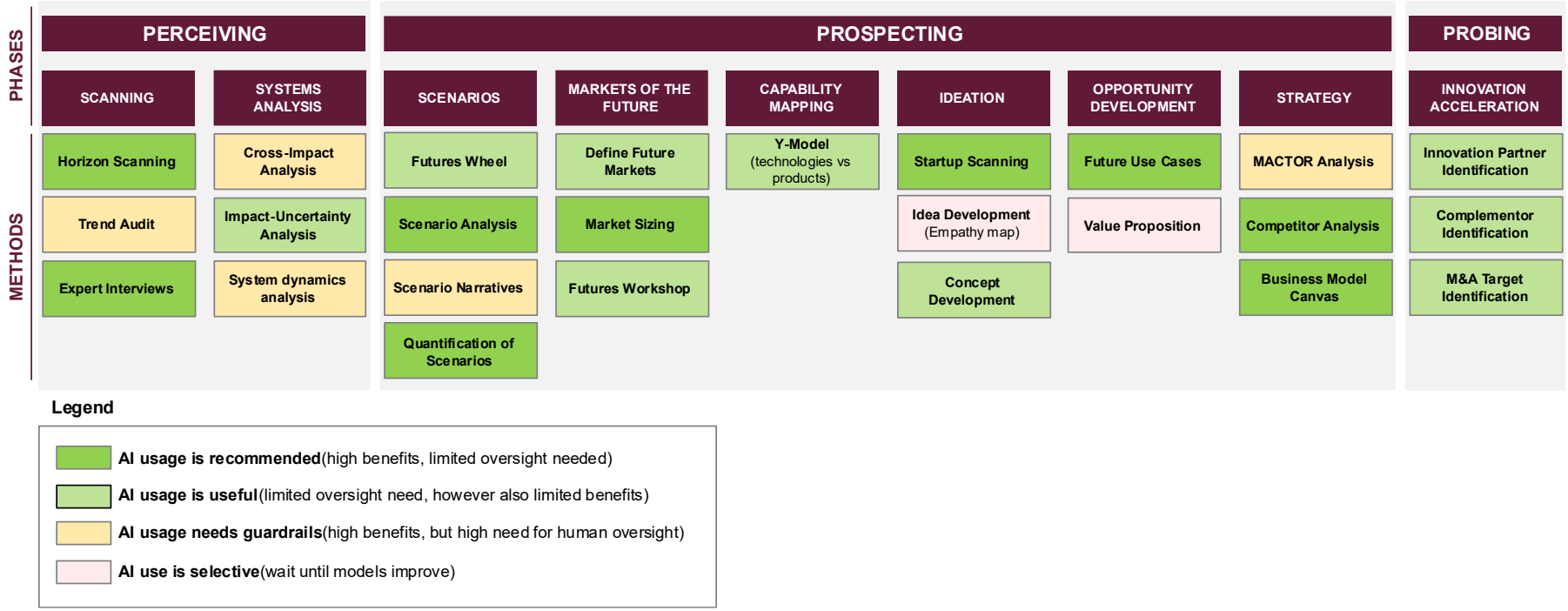


Figure 7: EDHEC Reference Model with the recommendation where to use AI (September 2026)

The heatmap points to a clear pattern of where GenAI earns its place today. The strongest case for integration, shown in **dark green**, concentrates in the **data-intensive parts of Perceiving and Prospecting**. In the scanning phase, they are Horizon Scanning and Expert Interviews. In the prospecting phase, they are Scenario Analysis, Quantification of Scenarios, Market Sizing, Startup Scanning, Future Use Cases, Competitor Analysis, and Business Model Canvas. These are the methods where AI delivers the most reliable gains in speed, breadth, and rigour at limited human effort, and **where teams should focus their first adoption efforts**.

A **light green tier** also benefits from AI with **little oversight**, **but with more limited gains**. It includes Impact-Uncertainty Analysis, Futures Wheel, Define Future Markets, Futures Workshop, Y-Model, Concept Development, and the Probing methods Innovation Partner Identification, Complementor Identification, and M&A Target Identification. Here, AI speeds up the work with some material gain through data breadth and analytical rigour. In the deliberative methods, the value lies in human discussion rather than the artefact. In the Probing methods, contextual judgement, relationships, and accountability still dominate.

The **pale-yellow tier**, includes Trend Audit, Cross-Impact Analysis, System Dynamics Analysis, Scenario Narratives, and MACTOR Analysis, which saw **some of the largest gains, but only under strong guardrails**. Each is prone to false precision, contextual drift, or fluent framing errors when scores, matrices, and narratives are taken at face value. These methods reward **AI use only when an expert defines the categories**, re-rates the most consequential cells, and treats every output as a draft until validated. The **red cells** mark the **creative and value-defining methods**, Idea Development and Value Proposition. There, AI adds limited benefit for high human effort, so it is **best used selectively until models improve**. The grey cells, Road-mapping and Business Wargaming, have not yet been assessed.

The overarching recommendation follows the colour gradient. Lead with AI in scanning, scenario, and market analysis. Apply it under strong guardrails in the scoring, modelling, and narrative methods. Use it to accelerate the deliberative and Probing methods. Keep ideation and value definition human-led for now, while revisiting these placements as the tools improve on a quarterly cadence.

High Value Use Cases

From Scenario descriptions to videos and gaming strategy

GenAI removes many of the bottlenecks previously attached to scenario creation(Rowland & Grüning, 2025). In our pilots, a sprint of scenario-making that previously took fourteen days now takes less than three.

The most impressive speed and productivity gain is achieved in the phase from the raw description of the scenarios, in our case, a few bullet points on the key factors that constitute the scenarios, to the scenario videos. GenAI tools in general, and in our case, the use of Claude (version 4.8) allowed us to develop scenario descriptions and after some human adjustments, the final version of scenario narratives in 1 hour. Speed did not come from skipping review. As Figure 8 shows, the AI stress-tested the scenario sets for consistency and distinctiveness, the analyst forced divergence and refined the outputs, and the stakeholder validated them against the set intent before signing off. Equally fast was the translation from the narratives into video scripts. Again, some human intervention was necessary, but a half day later, we had strong video scripts.

For turning scripts into videos, GenAI is also a powerful tool (Di Zio et al., 2023; Kuosa & Aalto, 2025). In our pilots, we used Sora 2[1] to develop the scenario videos. Below you can find the workflow, scenario posters, the scenario profile and the QR code takes you to the scenario videos.

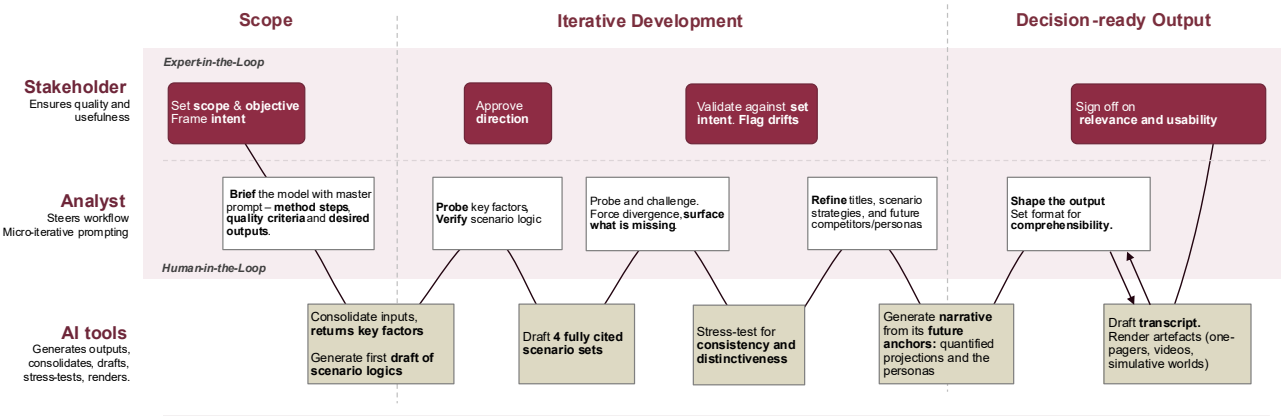


Figure 8: AI-Human process for scenario creation

[1] Sora 2, (accessed June 2026), https://openart.ai/suite/animate-video/sora2?

Scenario Narrative

Illustrative example

SCENARIO 1 — Algorithmic Shake-Out

Core Logic
AI becomes *substitutive*, not just augmentative, while markets remain globally connected.
What the world looks like in 2035
AI agents design, code, test, migrate, and optimise systems end-to-end. Platforms bundle strategy, implementation, and optimisation. Marginal cost of "good enough IT" collapses.
Industry Structure
Many incumbents disappear or shrink dramatically
A few AI-native integrators dominate global markets
Consulting firms polarise: hyperscale vs. hyper-specialist
Clients
Expect speed, automation, and outcome guarantees
Buy platforms, not projects
Switch providers easily
Talent
Junior consulting roles largely gone
Premium on system architects, AI governors, trust brokers
Profitability trajectory
Highly polarized — "winner-takes-most"
Margin Logic
Top performers:
Very high operating margins (30–45%)
Near-zero marginal cost delivery
Platform + IP-driven economics
Most incumbents:
Sharp margin erosion (single digits or negative)
Pricing pressure from AI-native competitors
High transition costs
Key Drivers
Collapse of billable hours logic
Extreme scalability of AI platforms
Price transparency and client switching

Scan for AI-generated scenario videos

Scenario Artefacts



Future Competitor Artefacts

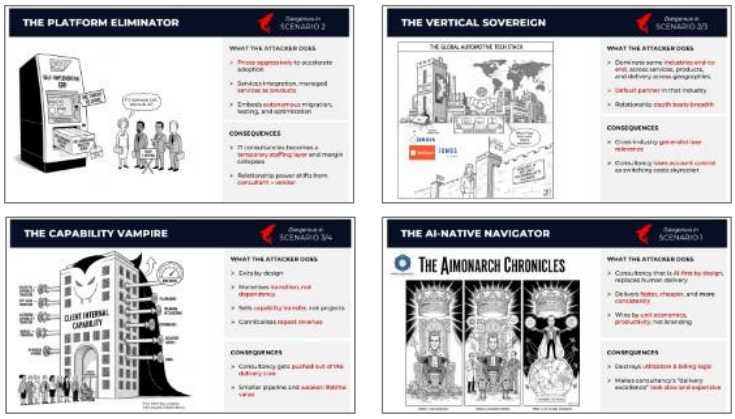


Figure 9: The process to create scenarios, transcripts and videos with AI

MACTOR analysis - building a detailed understanding of stakeholder interests

In our pilots, AI cut roughly sixty per cent of the analyst effort from MACTOR, saving one to three days on a typical foresight sprint. It also helps to broaden the perspectives of the human analysts. Every analyst has his/her own background and experience. AI can complement by identifying more actors and more objectives. AI also proved usable for assessing the position of actors towards objectives, as well as mapping direct and indirect influence relationships and calculating the resulting alliance and conflict matrices. In our case, all matrices were cross-checked in workshops to ensure good quality output and stakeholder buy-in.

The real value of AI-assisted MACTOR lies in the ability to pre-fill the matrices and to broaden our initial thinking. In addition, it is useful that it can adjust practically in real time with new stakeholder feedback, for example, during workshops.

One key tension is that when an AI tool fills in the matrices across often 100 – 200 cells, it becomes impractical for humans to verify, and the risk that it is not checked is high. One workaround is to test the AI on a subset of the matrix, and only once the rating has proven reliable, the AI is allowed to fill the rest of the matrix.

In our pilot on Home Energy Management System (HEMS), the AI-MACTOR workflow produced a Matrix of Indirect Influence (MIDI). Each cell captures an actor's influence through at least one intermediary power-projection mechanism through the network, rather than only in direct interactions. Rows give an actor's total indirect influence (Ii*); columns its total indirect dependence (Di*). The companion influence-dependence diagram makes the secondary effects visible and identifies the critical bridges and buffers in the system.

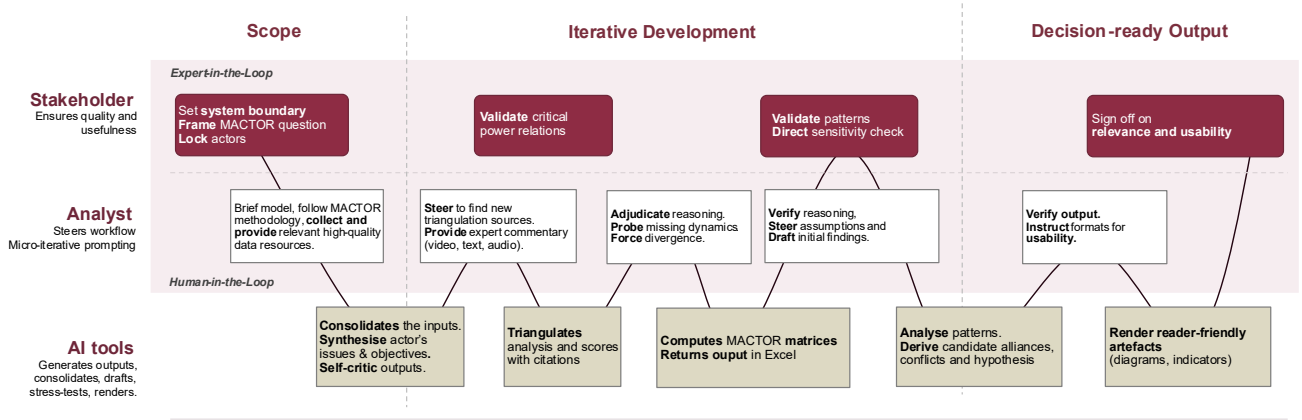


Figure 10: AI-Human process for MACTOR

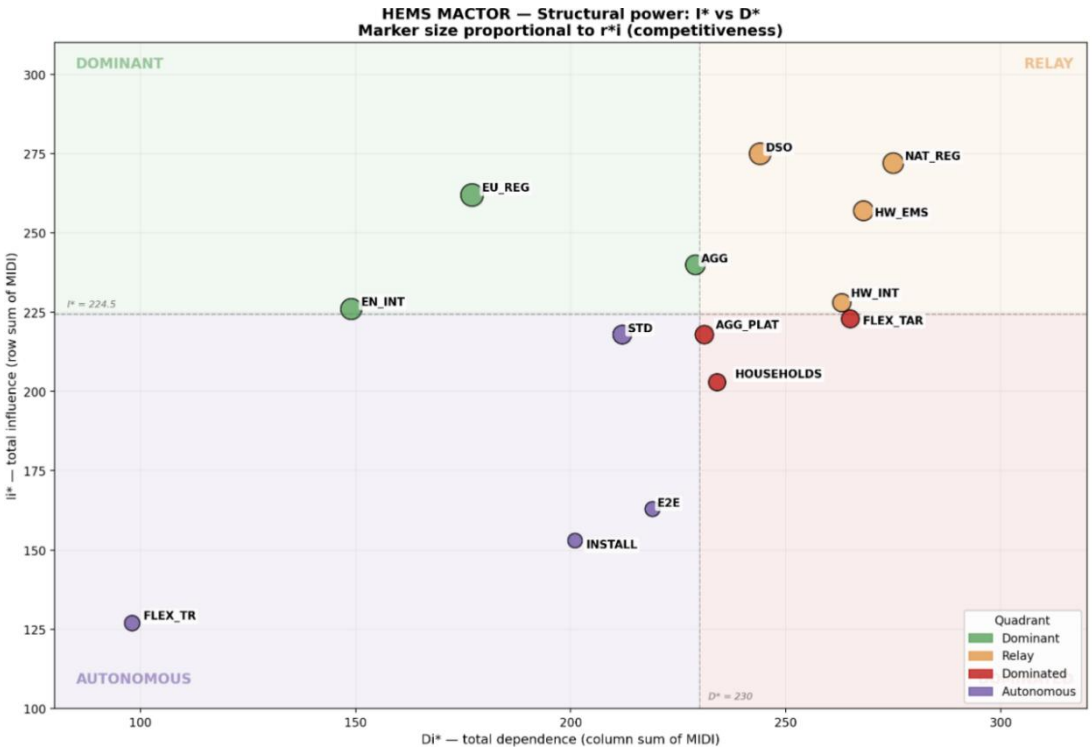


Figure 11: The MACTOR plot reveals the group of actors that align and oppose each other

The MACTOR analysis can, for other pilots, be expanded with additional output formats that serve additional purposes, which were, however, out of scope for our pilot.

Sizing new markets

The productivity gain in market sizing comes mostly in a specific configuration: AI paired with historic, pre-validated baselines, which gives the AI a credible anchor against which its retrieved data can be reconciled. Without that pairing, the value flattens; with it, the AI gathers, cross-checks, and reconciles at a scale no analyst team can easily achieve.

Two findings widen this value. First, AI scales gracefully across variables. With AI, generating estimates for an entire portfolio takes almost the same time as for a single market, whereas an analyst's time grows linearly with the number of elements. Review still scales with the portfolio, so total time grows, but far more slowly. Second, AI changes what re-estimation costs. When an underlying assumption shifts, or a new data source becomes available, the entire sizing can be re-triggered at near-zero marginal cost, and the analyst's job becomes deciding when to re-trigger the estimations with better-adjusted assumptions.

AI's estimate is only as good as the baseline it can anchor against. Where a credible reference point exists in the literature, the AI uses it well and produces defensible numbers. Where none exists, as in most novel categories, it invents one. Pushing back on a suspect estimate does not improve matters: rather than re-examining the underlying assumptions, the AI rebuilds the same answer in more defensive language, with a working that becomes non-verifiable. Our pilots show that AI estimation is most reliable on short and medium horizons where baselines

exist, and least reliable on the long horizons and novel categories. A second constraint sits alongside the first: scope. With no explicit boundary set before the work begins, the AI produces volumes of figures, few of which sit inside the question that is asked.

What works, in response, is AI under tight human oversight rather than AI under general supervision. The productive uses are specific: data gathering at scale across thousands of public filings with full source citation back to primary documents; triangulation that flags discrepancies between sources and detects circular sourcing; sensitivity analyses that surface which assumptions actually drive the answer; and first-pass estimates that the analyst audits and overrides rather than building from scratch. Two pilot-specific lessons sit on top of these. For novel fields, no single AI produces a credible estimate; a mix of LLMs, cross-checked against each other, is the only way to surface where any one of them is hallucinating an anchor. And the audit trail has to stay human-paced. The AI can generate citations and reconciliations in minutes, but the review of those citations should be done by the humans in the loop.

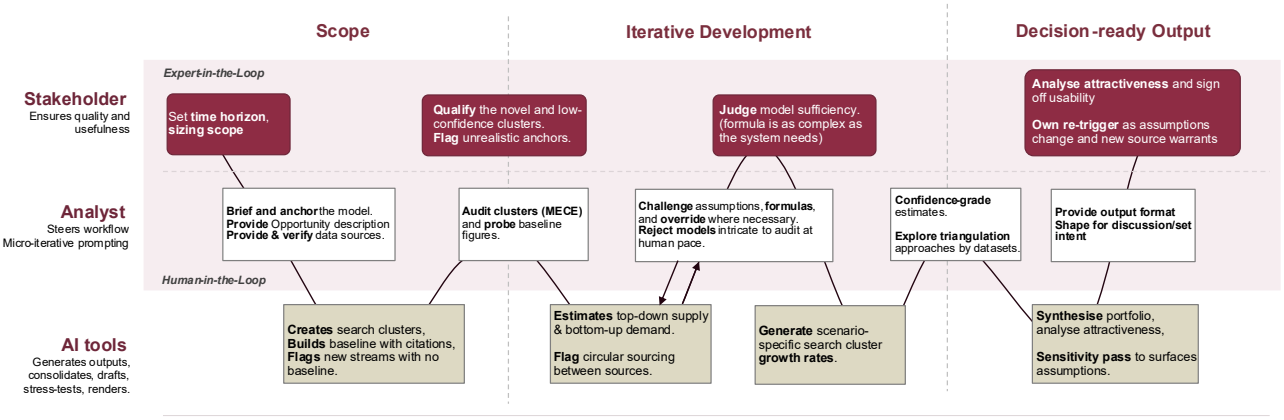


Figure 12: AI-Human market sizing process

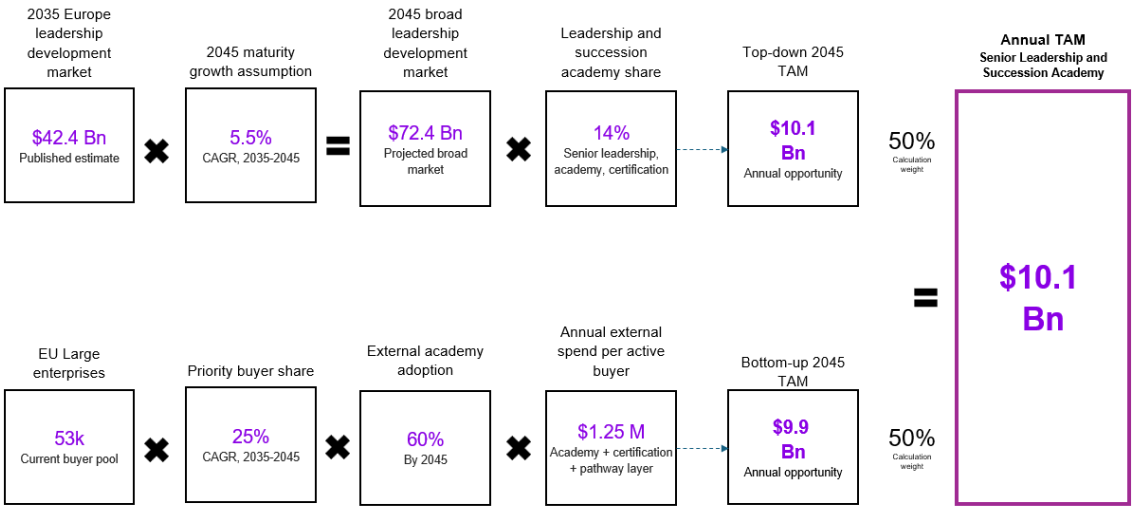


Figure 13: Market sizing output for pilot on Future of Executive Education. The 2045 horizon lies beyond the range where AI estimation is most reliable. The estimate is anchored on a published 2035 forecast and extended with an explicit growth assumption. Read as an order of magnitude.

SIEMENS

Case study: AI for New Innovation Search Fields

An apprentice who starts at Siemens today will finish training two to three and a half years from now, in a business that data, software and AI will have reshaped. Siemens Professional Education (SPE), responsible for vocational training, dual degrees and reskilling across a workforce of more than 290,000. SPE faces a complex planning challenge where educational offerings must be aligned not only with current business needs, but also with anticipated future developments under conditions of uncertainty and long planning horizons.

Every two years, the strategic foresight capability at SPE reviews the existing Trend radar. The team then defines search fields across technology, business, and the world of work and education. Within them, it scans reports and interviews experts to identify emerging trends, then assesses each trend for its strategic relevance and its time to impact. The most relevant are clustered into learning initiatives, each describing the capabilities Siemens will need.

Until 2023, this cycle was entirely human-driven including forty expert interviews, assessing sixty trends on the SPE Trend Radar, and running internal prioritisation workshops. Since 2024, SPE gradually introduced AI into the process, from scanning and interview synthesis to drafting trend profiles, in order to strengthen its experts.

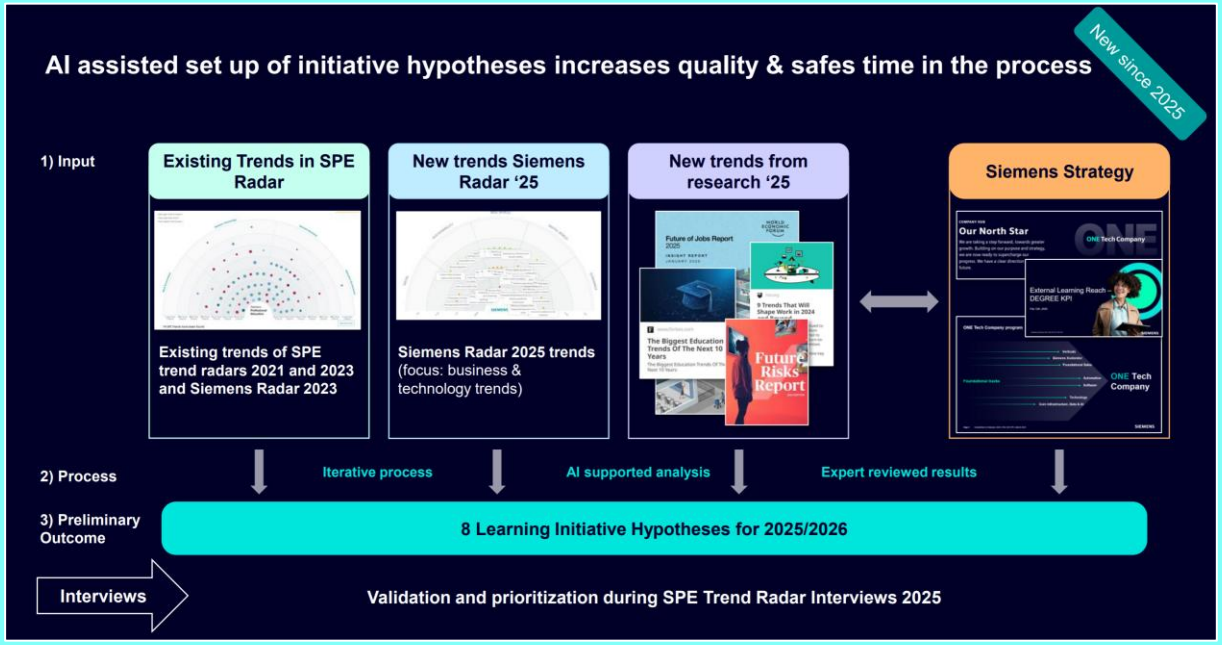


Figure 14: Siemens SPE AI augmented process for new innovation search fields

The gains with AI were apparent as AI let the team scan a far larger set of reports, identify new and merge overlapping trends, and draft hypotheses for new innovation fields, each linked to Siemens' strategy. From these, it proposed eight learning initiatives. Experts rated them in the Trend Radar interviews, then split, narrowed and reframed them, and carried four forward.

On systematically assessing the AI-augmented process against the 2023 baseline, the **cycle ran about 20 percent faster**. **Expert time fell by around half**, even as spending on external foresight and AI advice went up. The researchers estimated that **analytical quality rose by 30 percent,** mostly because the scan reached further.

What did not change was scoping and framing. As one division CTO put it:

> *AI tools will not be the differentiator; that takes human intelligence.*

René Rohrbeck, Stephan Szuppa, Julia Schmidt, *Artificial intelligence in strategic foresight: Evidence from a longitudinal case at Siemens Professional Education*, Futures, Volume 183, 2026, 103883, ISSN 0016-3287, https://doi.org/10.1016/j.futures.2026.103883

Performance, Benefits and Risks

Model evolution and performance

The model developer's race is in full swing, and the performance improvements, even in short periods of time are significant. The chart below shows how quickly the frontier has moved. In little more than a year the leading scores have roughly tripled: OpenAI's GPT-4.1, released in April 2025, scores 19 points, whereas by June 2026, OpenAI's GPT-5.5 reaches 55. The same pace is visible across developers: the earlier GPT-4o snapshot scores just 12, while the current frontier clusters between 54 and 60, led by Anthropic's Claude Opus 4.8 (56) and Claude Fable 5 (60), with Google's Gemini 3.5 Flash and 3.1 Pro Preview close behind.[2]

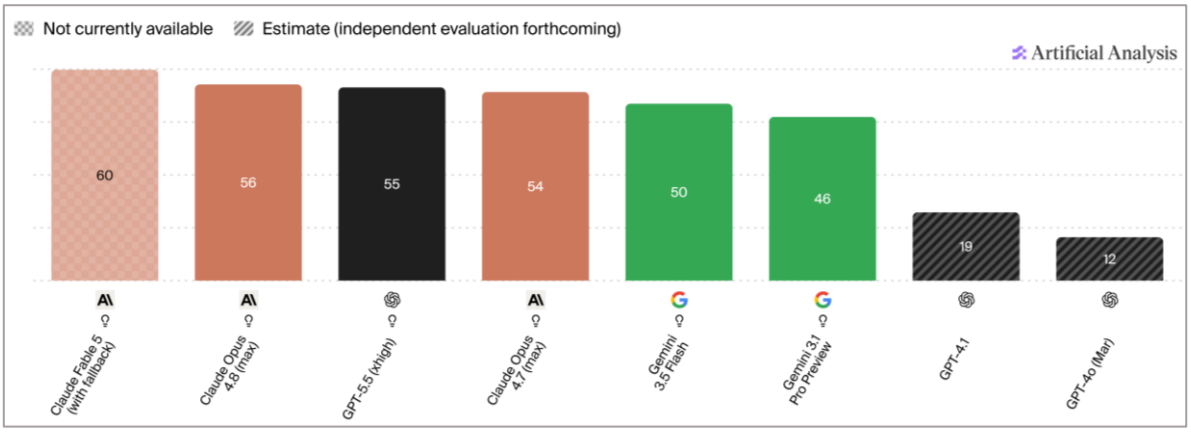


Figure 15: Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index (v4.1), leading models as of June 2026

The ranking is based on the Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index, a composite measure that combines nine separate evaluations into a single score. Together these span economically valuable real-world tasks, agentic tool use, software engineering, scientific and expert-level reasoning, factual breadth and long-context comprehension, so the index rewards all-round capability rather than strength on any single skill. Two caveats apply when reading the bars: hatched columns are preliminary estimates awaiting independent verification, and the checkered column marks a model that was not yet available for testing at the time of writing.

The persisting problem of hallucination

Stronger models are not automatically more reliable. The AA-Omniscience Index scores knowledge reliability from −100 to +100, rewarding correct answers, penalising hallucinations and applying no penalty for declining to answer, so 0 marks as many correct as incorrect answers. Progress is real but incomplete: GPT-4.1 scores −36, more wrong than right, whereas GPT-5.5 reaches 20 and Claude Fable 5 leads at 40, which is, however, still far below the 100-point ceiling.

[2] Source: Artificial Analysis, AI Model & API Providers Analysis | Artificial Analysis

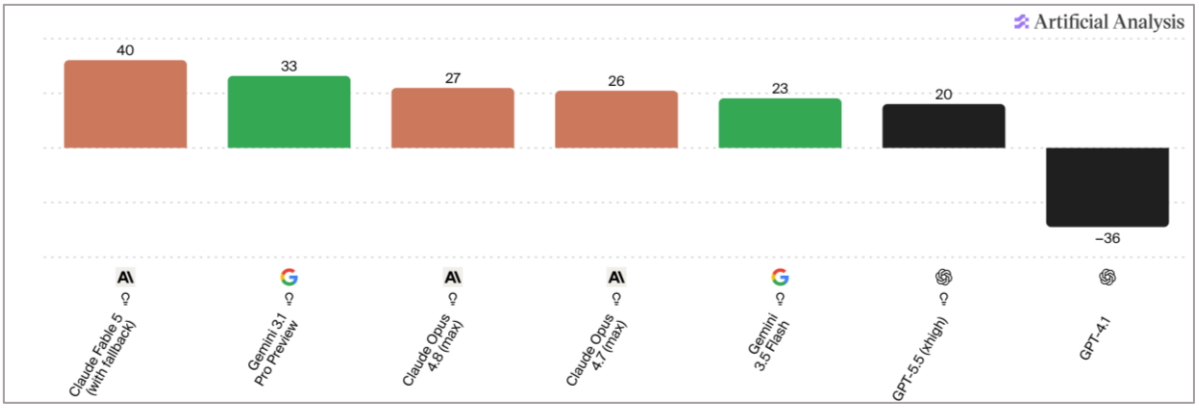


Figure 16: AA-Omniscience Index — knowledge reliability of leading models, June 2026

The order also differs from the overall intelligence ranking, so capability and trustworthiness need to be judged separately.

AI makes powerful formats available for all

Beyond general-purpose models, specialised AI tools make formats that were once slow and costly to produce available to everyone. For foresight, text-to-video generators are particularly interesting: they turn a written scenario into a short, vivid film in minutes, putting powerful scenario videos within reach of any team. Quality is rising fast. In blind preference voting, the leading models now sit within a narrow band, led by HappyHorse 1.0, Kling 3.0 and Sora 2.

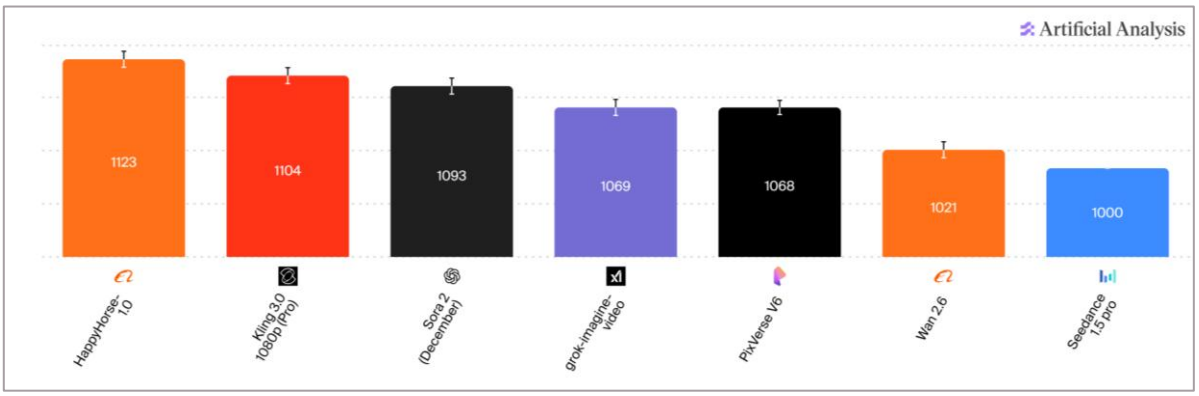


Figure 17: Text-to-Video (with Audio) Leaderboard — Elo scores from blind preference votes, June 2026

What benefits to expect

GenAI's contribution is real but conditional. Each benefit below comes with the condition under which it actually materialises.

WHAT GENAI ENABLES	THE CONDITION FOR IT TO PAY OFF
Speed and scale. Scanning, synthesis, and drafting that once took weeks compress into days, and a far larger evidence base can be processed.	Speed is not a strategic value. Teams have to reinvest the time saved into interpretation and challenge, or they simply produce mediocre foresight faster.
Broader coverage, lower omission risk. AI covers far more known sources and surfaces adjacencies and cross-domain connections that a single analyst would miss.	Breadth only helps if humans then prioritise. More options without sharper judgment make everything look equally relevant.
Structure and consistency. Standardised trend profiles, scenario sets, and comparison tables become fast and repeatable.	AI amplifies method quality. Strong methods become faster and more repeatable; weak methods become polished but fragile.
Accessibility of complex methods. Cross-impact matrices, actor maps, and quantified scenarios are now within reach of teams without a dedicated specialist.	These outputs look rigorous even when assumptions are weak. Accessibility raises the governance burden; it does not lower it.
AI as a checker, not just a producer. Used well, AI stress-tests reasoning, hunts for contradictions, and flags weak signals and counterintuitive patterns.	AI defaults to dominant narratives unless explicitly instructed to look for asymmetry and disagreement. The contrarian prompt must be deliberate.
Organisational knowledge as advantage. Pointed at internal data and context, AI produces foresight specific to the firm rather than generic to the market.	Teams relying only on public web sources get the same foresight as everyone else. The edge comes from proprietary inputs and expert framing.

Table 1: Benefits of AI and how to lift them

What to watch out for

The same capabilities create characteristic failure modes. Several of them share a root, which one member put plainly:

> *AI clusters by statistical probability, and we all end up in the big convergence.*

These are the risks to design against.

RISK	WHY IT MATTERS
Foresight theatre. AI produces large volumes of plausible, well-formatted material.	The danger is not only wrong information but content that looks useful, does not change anyone's thinking and may still be inaccurate.
False precision. Scores, rankings, years, and percentages attach hard numbers to uncertain futures.	Quantified output feels like an objective measurement and invites more confidence than the underlying evidence supports.
Generic synthesis. AI flattens nuance, especially across long inputs, mixed domains, or weakly structured prompts.	A trend can be evidence-linked and still useless if users cannot see what is changing, why it matters, and what it affects.
Dominant-logic reinforcement. AI inherits common narratives from training data and public discourse.	It over-ranks trends that are already visible, narratively rich, or Anglo-American in framing, and quietly buries the asymmetric ones.
Context drift. Long sessions degrade quality as contradictions and early errors carry forward.	Without reset points and quality checks built into the workflow, the output gets worse the longer the session runs.
Low trust in final outputs. Experts and decision-makers left out of framing, scoring, and interpretation.	Trust comes from participation in the reasoning. An artefact handed down from a tool nobody helped build does not get adopted.

Table 2: Risks of AI and how to design for them

Tips and Hacks: Five Calls to Action

If you take nothing else from this report, take these five. They are the practices the Community returns to again and again, the ones that separate teams getting real strategic value from GenAI from those generating polished material that changes nothing. None of them is exotic. Together, they are the difference between hybrid intelligence and AI-flavoured outsourcing.

Test AI across everything you do

The single biggest predictor of whether someone finds GenAI useful is whether they have tried it on their own work. The OECD–WEF survey found that 90% of foresight practitioners who had used AI rated it moderately to highly useful, against only 49% of those who had not. Organisational confidence in AI is built one person and one task at a time, by doing rather than discussing.

"Test everything" does not mean "deploy everything." It means giving every team explicit permission, and a small amount of structured time, to try a recurring task with and without AI and to capture what they learn.

> *In coming years, the most intelligent organisations will need to blend technology-enabled insights with a sophisticated understanding of human judgment, reasoning, and choice. Those that do this successfully will have an advantage over their rivals.*
>
> *Paul J.H. Schoemaker & Philip E. Tetlock*

What good looks like. Every team has run at least one of its recurring deliverables through AI in the past quarter. Leaders model the behaviour by sharing what they tried and what they learned, including the failures. A lightweight log of experiments is kept and reviewed monthly, and time spent experimenting is treated as work, not as an extracurricular activity.

Watch-out. Experimentation without reflection becomes noise. The point is to build collective judgment about where GenAI helps and where it hurts, not to count tools tried. Pair every experiment with a few minutes of structured reflection: was the output usable, did it save time, would I trust it on a higher-stakes task?

In our own pilot, we ran horizon scanning and clustering twice, once as a human-only process and once as an AI-augmented process, and found that both versions carried blind spots around weak signals. We added an "N−1" pass specifically to surface the signals each approach had missed, and that step is now a permanent part of the workflow. Several partners reported arriving at the same practice independently, which is itself a useful signal about where the method needs reinforcement. It is the stance one partner recommends to everyone:

> *Treat GenAI as a laboratory partner: experiment on real work, measure its contribution against a known baseline, and learn alongside other practitioners as the technology evolves.*

Adopt a disciplined way of working with AI

Define intent, output formats, and quality indicators before you prompt.

The gap between an average GenAI output and a genuinely useful one almost always comes down to discipline in how the tool is used. Four components matter. **Prompt design** means stating role, context, task, format, and quality criteria explicitly. **Tool selection** means matching the model to the task, a fast general model for ideation, a more capable one for analysis, a specialised one for code or data. **Output formats** mean asking for structured results (tables, ranked lists, JSON) that can be reviewed and reused rather than free-form prose that has to be re-read. **Quality indicators** mean defining in advance what good looks like, so reviewers know what to check.

> *The biggest shift required is to move quality control from the research process to the results. You cannot easily audit how an AI got somewhere, so you have to ask it to reveal its reasoning and check if it meets your quality criteria.*

None of this is new. It is what good professional practice has always demanded of research and analysis: specification, method, review. GenAI does not relax those requirements, it raises them, because the volume of plausible-looking output is so much larger.

What good looks like. Teams keep a shared, version-controlled library of prompts for their recurring tasks and improve it over time. Outputs are requested in structured, human-readable formats wherever possible. Each significant AI-assisted deliverable is reviewed against pre-defined quality criteria, not just a sense that it "looks right." Prompt and tool choice are documented alongside the output, so the work can be reproduced and audited.

Watch-out. Discipline can tip into bureaucracy. The goal is reliable, reviewable output, not a prompt-governance committee. Keep the overhead proportional to the stakes of the task. The discipline earns its keep most visibly on heavy analytical work: in our pilot, reviewing the reasoning behind a single 18x18 cross-impact analysis meant working through 306 individual cells, and only pre-defined quality criteria made that review tractable.

Put security guardrails in place

Before you scale, decide what data goes where.

Data leakage is the most cited barrier to GenAI adoption in regulated, research-led, and contract-bound organisations. The OECD–WEF survey identified data security and confidentiality as a major barrier, particularly in the public sector. The risk is real, but the response cannot be to ban the technology, which simply drives use onto personal accounts and consumer tools.

The right response is to make the safe path the easy path. Three components matter most: a simple data classification with clear rules about what can go to a public model, what requires an enterprise tier with no training on inputs, and what must stay on-premises or be redacted; a sanctioned set of tools at each tier, so teams do not make vendor judgements case by case;

and vendor due diligence on training, retention, sub-processors, and incident response, reviewed annually rather than only at procurement.

What good looks like. Every employee can say in one sentence what they are allowed to paste into which tool. Sanctioned tools cover at least 80% of day-to-day use cases, because anything less pushes people around the policy. Vendor terms on training, retention, and sub-processing are reviewed at least annually, and there is a clear, blame-light route for reporting a data-handling mistake.

> *"A guardrail that drives behaviour underground is worse than no guardrail at all."*

Watch-out. Guardrails that are too restrictive create shadow AI, with employees using personal accounts because the official tools are too slow or too limited. Approaches vary widely in practice: one of our more security-conscious partners redacts confidential passages before uploading a document for processing, while others rely on a clearly communicated list of what must never be shared, backed by individual responsibility and good faith. The common lesson was to have an open conversation with the team before setting the rules, not after.

Adopt a tool-agnostic approach

The model landscape is consolidating around a small number of frontier providers, but their relative position shifts on a quarterly cadence. Any architecture that hard-codes a specific model, vendor, or agent framework into core workflows is building in a lock-in problem that will be painful to undo.

A tool-agnostic approach means designing prompts, workflows, and integrations against an abstraction layer rather than a single provider. In practice that means routing model calls through a thin internal gateway, so the model behind a workflow can be swapped without re-engineering; treating prompts and evaluation suites as first-class assets owned by the business rather than the vendor; keeping the ability to benchmark new models against current ones on real tasks rather than vendor demos; and avoiding deep dependencies on any one vendor's agent framework until standards mature.

What good looks like. The same business workflow can run on at least two model providers with minimal change. Prompts and evaluations live in a system the firm controls, not inside a vendor's console. There is a named owner for benchmarking new models on representative internal tasks, and contracts include reasonable exit and data-portability provisions.

Watch-out. Tool-agnosticism can become an excuse to do nothing, a posture of waiting until the market settles. The point is the opposite: build now, but build so you can swap components as the market evolves.

Keeping humans in the loop, effectively

"Human-in-the-loop" risks becoming a slogan. To make it operational, organisations need to be specific about what humans are in the loop for. Three things, distinct and non-negotiable. **Accountability**: someone with a name is answerable for the output of an AI-assisted process, not the model, the tool, or "the system." **Quality**: the reviewer checks whether the output meets the standards of objectivity, reliability, and validity the firm requires, standards that predate AI and do not relax for it. **Judgment**: the human brings context, ethical reasoning, and tacit knowledge that the model does not have and cannot acquire.

This last point has a sharp practical edge. Traditional quality assurance has leaned heavily on auditing the process if it was the right method used, were the sources sound, was the reasoning valid. When AI does the legwork, the process is opaque by construction. The reviewer's job shifts from "was the method sound" to "is the conclusion correct, useful, and defensible." That is a harder question, and it calls for more senior judgement, not less. Our pilot tested this shift directly: for every method, the AI-augmented approach was assessed at two separate levels, the throughput and the output quality, precisely because the two can no longer be inferred from each other.

The pattern held across every method we piloted:

> *Treating AI as an autonomous scenario producer loses both quality and developmental value.*
>
> *Scenario analysis and narrative*

> *The method is not plug-and-play yet. Singular prompts produce weak outputs; good performance depends on iteration, structured workflow design, and explicit quality criteria.*
>
> *Horizon scanning*

> *Human oversight is non-negotiable for selecting what is credible, relevant, and strategically meaningful.*
>
> *Trend audit*

> *Trust in the final output will be low if one is not actively involved.*
>
> *MACTOR with Business Model Canvas*

To keep that involvement real rather than nominal, EDHEC logged every human steer applied during a method, a practice we describe as micro-iterative prompting.

Watch-out. Human-in-the-loop can become rubber-stamping in the loop. The reviewer needs the time, the brief, and the authority to push back, including the authority to reject an AI output and redo the work. Without that, the loop is theatre.

Micro-iterative prompting

The real value of expert prompting is not writing one perfect prompt. It is knowing how to steer the conversation in small, precise moves. This does not replace the master prompt. The master prompts in the prompt library sets the frame, method steps, quality criteria and output format. Micro-iteration does the steering within that frame.

In our testing, longer prompts helped set context but rarely produced decision-ready outputs in one go. The best results came when an expert stayed close to the work: asking for a first pass, spotting where the answer was too generic, correcting the logic, tightening the frame, and pushing the model toward a sharper output. This is micro-iterative prompting, and it works because experts can see what is missing.

> *Prompting is becoming less of a technical skill and more of a foresight craft skill.*

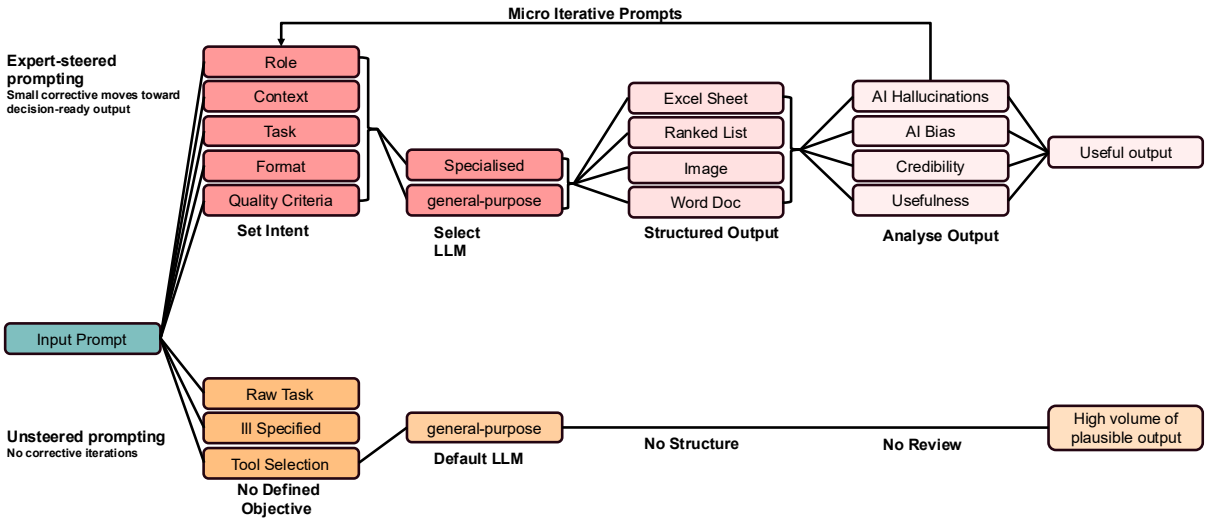


Figure 18: Micro-iterative prompting: the expert steers the model through successive small corrections rather than a single prompt

The figure shows the pattern in practice. Rather than one long instruction followed by a finished answer, the expert and the model exchange a series of short, corrective turns, each one closing the gap between a generic first draft and a decision-ready output. Three examples from our pilots show what those corrective moves look like.

When asking AI to identify trends from a horizon scan, a non-expert may accept a list such as "AI regulation," "climate pressure," or "changing consumer behaviour." An expert intervenes: *"These are too broad. Rephrase them as specific developments, with a clear direction of change, affected actors, and evidence logic."* The output immediately becomes more useful.

In scenario work, AI may produce plausible but conventional futures. An expert prompt might say: *"This scenario is too linear. Identify the underlying uncertainty, remove forecast-like language, and make the tension between actors more visible."* Again, quality improves because the human knows what good looks like.

The same applies to scoring. AI can fill a matrix, but an expert asks: *"Which scores are most uncertain? Where might the dominant narrative be misleading us? Which cells need human validation?"* This turns AI from a producer into a sparring partner.

The uncomfortable truth is that clarifying questions only help when the human can judge the answer. Micro-iteration is not trial and error, it is expert steering. The analyst brings method, context, and quality criteria; AI brings speed, structure, and alternative formulations. That division is why prompting is becoming less of a technical skill and more of a foresight craft skill.

Building your own practice

Adopting AI is a journey, and the path dips before it climbs. Moving from a human-only baseline to individual AI-augmented methods, productivity first falls. Individually or as a team, the effort of learning to prompt, steer and check the tools outweighs the early gains, so teams should brace for a short-term reduction. One member described what that dip feels like from the inside:

> *Efficiency gains get wiped out, and you find yourself starting from scratch for the hundredth time.*

The curve describes the organisation's learning cost. Individual methods can show large gains early, as our pilots did, with scenario sprints falling from fourteen days to under three and MACTOR effort falling by roughly 60%. Across an organisation, those gains are first absorbed by the effort of learning to prompt, steer and check. Only once mature workflows are in place does overall performance return to, and then exceed, the human-only baseline, and it is mainly through agents that the gains become significant organisation-wide. The path also forks: chasing speed alone leads to the "AI trap" of fast but low-quality and unverifiable output. Human effort shifts from cognitive work to orchestration along the way, and the size of each bubble reflects the impact across the organisation.

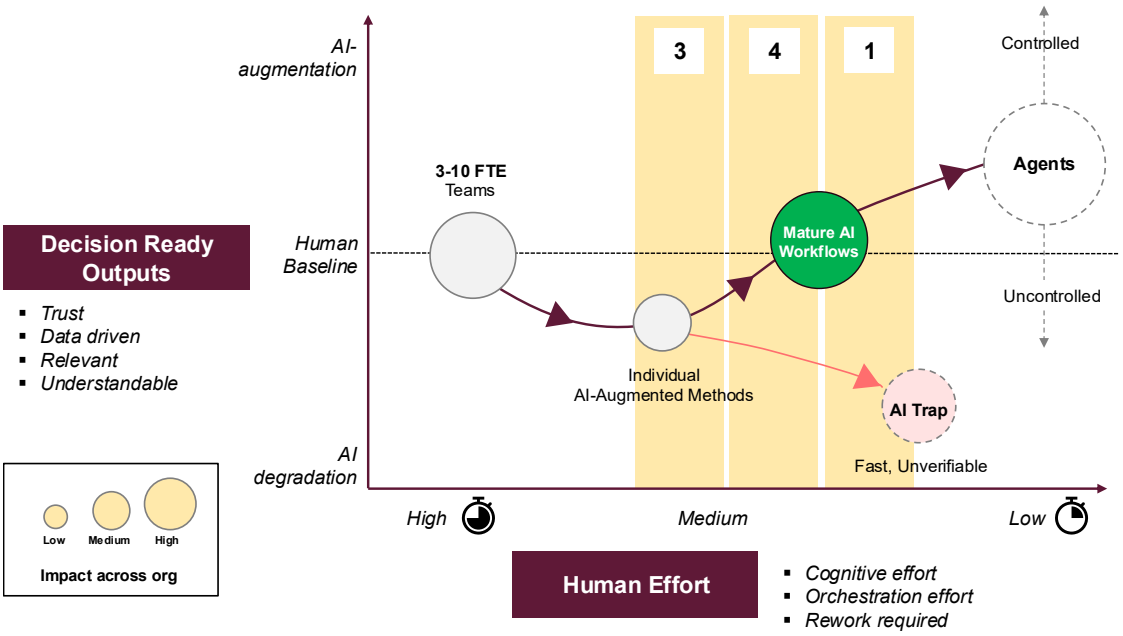


Figure 19: Knowing where you are going and avoiding the short-term disappointment trap. Numbers show where Community members placed themselves on 19 June 2026.

The numbered bands show where our eight members organisations placed themselves at our third workshop on 19 June 2026. Three were testing and building AI-augmented methods. Four were climbing out of the quality dip and towards mature AI workflows. One had gone further, to the point where the path forks between controlled agents and the AI trap.

LUFTHANSA GROUP

Case Study: Managing data quality for hybrid intelligence

Lufthansa Innovation Hub (LIH) is the Lufthansa Group's strategic intelligence unit. It brings together external intelligence on markets and competitors, customers, emerging technologies and long-term futures, and connects it with the group's own data from operations, cargo, and airports. So the group can respond to change, anticipate it and help shape it. AI lets Lufthansa Group do this at the speed the aviation industry now moves. But what makes it work sits underneath: the data.

Few industries meet as many forces at once. The Lufthansa Group spans passenger airlines, cargo and maintenance, each with its own markets, regulations and trade press, and all exposed to fuel costs, geopolitics and climate regulation at the same time. Intelligence in such complex organisations is usually compiled in cycles rather than accumulated, and general-purpose AI is not a fix to that. Ask a model how aircraft maintenance will change over the next decade, and you are likely to get a sensible and fluent answer, much the same as another competitor would.

The challenge, then, is to build what most organisations lack: a shared taxonomy across business units, a curated source base, and a structured stack of signals, trends, themes, questions and problems that deepens over time. This is how LIH built it.

LIH's intelligence edge rests on its data foundation and futures methodology. Its data spans the value chain from input to impact, from patents, research grants and funding, partnerships and product launches, to customer feedback, user sentiment, new markets and competitors. Sources are qualified in tiers, and AI agents monitor them continuously, from thought leaders to the trade press of cargo and maintenance. A taxonomy is defined that turns this into thematic intelligence that grows as strategy, products, ESG priorities and business requirements evolve. Built on open protocols such as the Model Context Protocol, the foundation is LLM-agnostic: it can be queried from ChatGPT, Claude or other assistants. Furthermore, AI makes the output shareable as a tailored report and in an always-on workspace, where corporate development, partnership and innovation teams explore, follow trends and take the intelligence into their decisions.

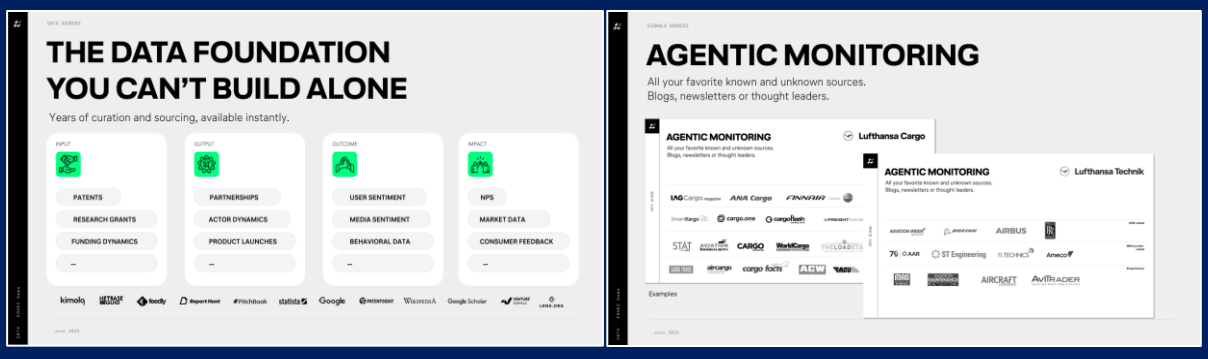


Figure 20: LIH data pipelines and automated signal monitoring (illustrative)

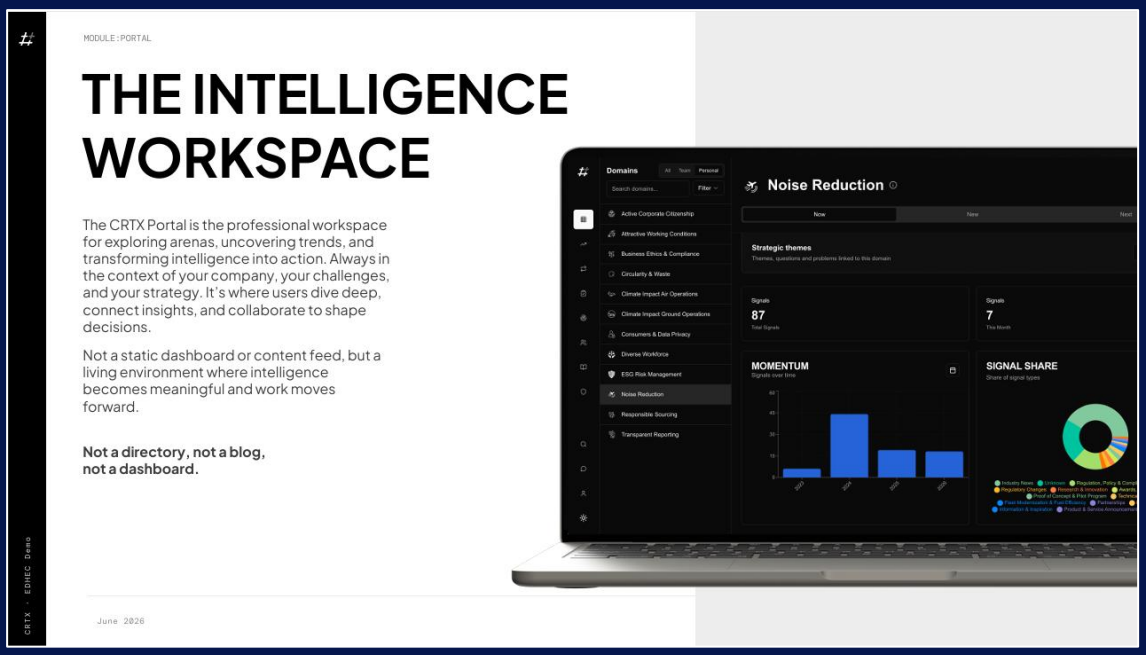


Figure 21: LIH intelligence workspace (illustrative)

LIH shows what the next stage of hybrid intelligence looks like for them: AI that acts at the speed of change because it stands on proprietary data no competitor can buy. But the deeper lesson is that this was a data-led transformation before it was an AI one. By treating its data as a strategic asset, LIH turned foresight from a periodic exercise into a continuous capability that every business unit can draw on.

The order of things matters. **Qualify your sources** before you scale your prompts, **define your taxonomy** before you search, and **treat curation as a standing responsibility**. As data volumes grow, selecting and governing your own data will matter more, and it will get harder.

Many thanks to Tino Klaehne, Principal Futurist at Lufthansa Innovation Hub, for sharing their practice.

Conclusion

What is now possible

The pilot work behind this paper makes one thing clear. Generative AI today is a credible force multiplier for the parts of business exploration that are research-heavy, synthesis-heavy, and pattern-heavy. Horizon scanning that took weeks can take days. Scenario drafts that once required a workshop to produce can be generated overnight, leaving the workshop free to refine them. Stakeholder mapping, signal clustering, and first-draft communication assets are all materially faster, and often broader, with AI assistance than without.

For organisations that adopt the five calls to action, the gains are not incremental. The point is not that the machine does the work faster. It is that senior people are freed from first-pass production to spend their time on the work only humans can do: judgment, interpretation, and the framing of strategic choices.

What remains hard

Three things remain genuinely hard, and the reference model is honest about each.

The first is the forward-looking, inductive work that is the essence of foresight. Identifying weak signals, low-probability disruptions, and genuinely novel framings is precisely where GenAI is weakest, because it recombines what already exists rather than imagining what does not. It is also where the human search matters most, as one member reminded us:

> *The messy searching is what makes the work yours. It is where the lucky discoveries happen.*

The second is quality assurance. Knowing that an AI-assisted output is actually right, when the process that produced it is opaque, is an unresolved problem that will require senior human attention for the foreseeable future.

The third is cultural, and it is the hardest of all. The shift from process-quality to results-quality, and from tool adoption to disciplined practice, asks more of an organisation than the technology itself ever will.

None of these is a reason to wait. They are the reasons to start now, deliberately, and to build the judgment and the guardrails while the stakes of getting it wrong are still low.

An invitation

The EDHEC GenAI Community of Practice will continue to test, refine, and publish on these questions. The reference model presented here is a working starting point, grounded in real pilots rather than vendor claims, and it will change as the tools change. We invite practitioners to use it, push back on it, and contribute to its next iteration.

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The method one-pagers

Sitting beneath this report is a library of one-pagers, one for each foresight method we tested. They form the middle tier of the three-tier body of work described in the introduction, between the high-level reference model above and the detailed process documentation and prompt library. Each one-pager was derived the same way: we ran the method twice on our pilot case, once as a human-only process and once as an AI-augmented process and compared the two. The comparison is what generates the assessment, so every rating on a one-pager is a statement about how the AI-augmented approach performed relative to a human-only baseline, not an abstract score. All findings reflect the specific tools, prompts, source mix, and workflow conditions available at the time of testing, which matters given how quickly the underlying models change.

We used the following rating scale



Figure 22: Rating scale comparing AI-augmented against human-only method application

We will describe each foresight method and our assessment in a **one-pager consisting of:**

- **Method summary:** What the method does and how AI was integrated
- **Key insights:** The main takeaways from the test, highlighting drawbacks and improvements
- **Human oversight in the loop:** Process model of the AI-augmented workflow
- **Assessment:** We assess the approach with three indicators that are applied during method execution and three indicators assessed on the final result. The Scale ranges from -5 (strongly inferior to human-only process) to +5 (strongly superior).
- **Implications:** Lessons learned on scaling the process, team skills & workflows, expert involvement, and where GenAI now adds practical or strategic value.
- **Limitations:** Where caution is required, including issues such as articulation quality, credibility, hallucination issues, contextual awareness, prompt sensitivity, and source dependence.

The one-pagers are designed to be used as practical decision aids. When considering leveraging AI the one-pagers inform whether the approach is worth adopting, what it will cost in oversight, and where quality challenges remain. The Horizon Scanning sheet (our first method below) records roughly 12x faster scanning and a 78% gain in analyst productivity, but also a negative score on analytical breadth, because the scan stayed within its predefined scope and missed fringe signals. Read alongside the reference model, the one-pagers turn each colour-coded rating in the heatmap into an evidenced, reproducible account of how that rating was reached, and they point onward, through the output links, to the prompts and process detail needed to run the method.

HORIZON SCANNING

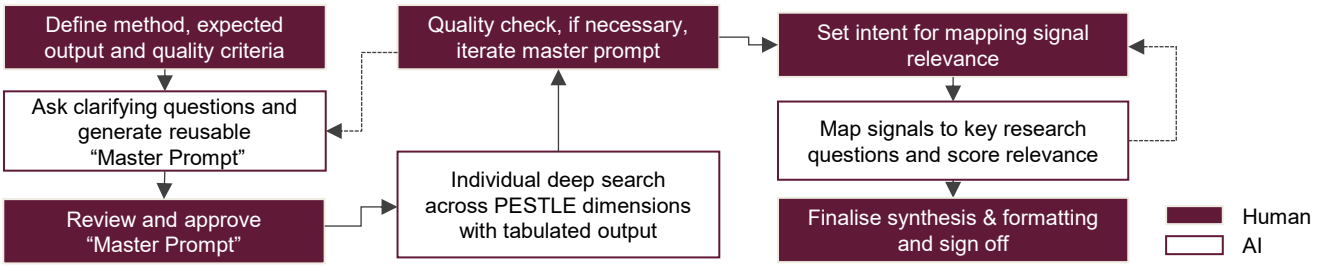
ChatGPT Deep Search | OUTPUT

Gen AI-augmented horizon scanning can expand the volume and speed of signal detection, helping foresight teams **cover more ground across themes and geographies**. Its value is **strongest** at the front end of scanning, where the **task is to surface, structure, and synthesise signals at scale**. It was found to be especially useful for broad sensing and for informing resource allocation more systematically.

KEY INSIGHTS

- **12x faster scanning** accelerates signal discovery but not autonomous
- Weak signals are hard to surface with AI alone.
- **Analyst skills shift** toward provocation, providing clarifications, detail-checking, and quality control.
- The **quality** of scanning outputs is highly **sensitive to scope & context volume**.
- **Token strategy** directly shapes depth, relevance, and synthesis.
- **Prompt architecture** matters more than the final prompt; AI-generated scanning prompts are key to method scalability.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+3	Reduced analyst effort by 78% (14 days to 3 days), with the analyst resource focused on oversight and refinement.
Throughput time	+3	Decreased by 57% (from 7 days to 3 days); accelerating signal spotting, relevance screening, and short-form synthesis cycles.
Reliability	0	Stable for high-volume scanning with a replicable workflow across several AI tools.
Analytical breadth	-2	Despite scanning 52 reports and 250 sources, generating 390 signals, the method was constrained by the predefined scope and did not capture any fringe signals outside it.
Credibility	0	Descriptions are coherent with credible references; weak signals require verification.
Usability for humans	+1	Produces structured, traceable signal lists, but ranking & prioritizing takes multiple passes.

IMPLICATIONS

- **Redefines the role of the foresight analyst** as scan architect, quality controller, and strategic interpreter.
- **Enables more systematic scanning across units** and multiple domains, particularly for recurring scans on shared themes.
- **Improves individual productivity immediately** without full team-scale transformation, improving output-per-analyst ratio.
- **Creates a basis for specialised scanning models**, i.e., prompt systems focused on geopolitics, regulation, or technology.
- **Opens a second-order use case for GenAI as a checker** to flag gaps and compare outputs.

LIMITATIONS

- **Generic synthesis remains a persistent weakness,** risking outputs to be low in strategic specificity.
- **Token limits shape output quality,** flattening nuance and reducing signal depth.
- **The method is not plug-and-play (yet)** as singular prompts produce weak outputs. Good performance depends on iteration, structured workflow design, and explicit quality criteria.
- **Source mix matters** as richer real-world inputs, such as podcasts, expert conversations, or other high-context qualitative sources, improved performance significantly.

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

TREND AUDIT

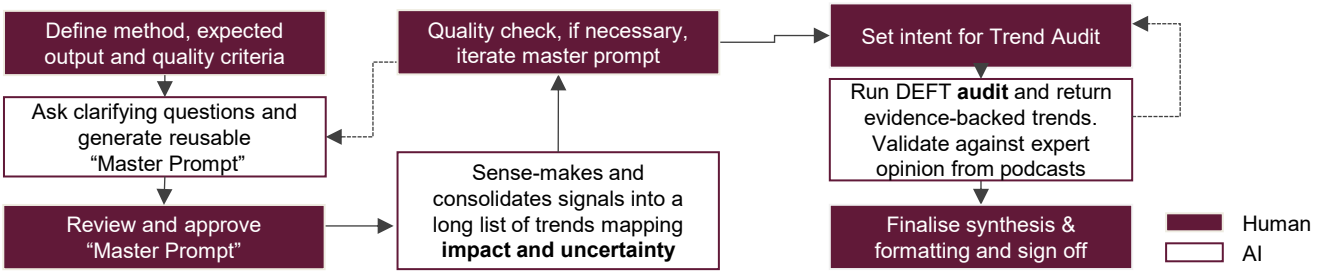
ChatGPT Deep Search | NotebookLM | Claude | OUTPUT

GenAI-augmented trend consolidation & audit turned large **signal inventories** into a usable **long list of trends,** tested them against **structured evidence finding** and validated against with expert opinions from **podcast transcripts**. Here, **codified trend logic** accelerated the first-pass DEFT audit, while credible **podcasts strengthened triangulation**. The method performed best when clear articulation standards was provided, and **the audit was structured in modular passes**.

KEY INSIGHTS

- AI sped up the process by **10 times**.
- AI handled trend sensemaking better than trend articulation.
- **Codified** trend architecture **improved throughput and consistency**.
- 12h of **podcast evidence** extended **validation without live SMEs**.
- Trend audit worked best in **modular** DEFT **passes**, **improving audit quality and control.**
- Final quality depended on **iterative refinement**, not first-pass output.
- Extended single-thread prompting **increased drift and hallucination risk**.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+2	Cut first-pass human effort by ~80% overall, from 164 hours of analyst/SME time to an AI-supported workflow led by one analyst
Throughput time	+2	Reduced cycle time by 40% for trend audit (5 days to 3) and by ~93% for expert-interview synthesis (3 weeks to 1 day)
Reliability	+2	The method proved scalable when trend logic, audit structure, and evidence inputs were clearly codified into the prompts
Analytical breadth	+1	Consolidated 390 signals into 43 trends, audited using the DEFT method, supported by 12 hours of podcasts, though the breadth still exceeded the quality of directional interpretation
Credibility	+1	Trend logic was generally evidence-linked, and podcast triangulation added confidence, though human validation remained necessary
Usability for humans	-1	Comprehensibility improved after prompt refinement, but articulation quality still varied

IMPLICATIONS

- **Makes business-unit input more targeted and on-demand** by reserving expert involvement for review, challenge, and contextualisation rather than first-pass synthesis.
- **Creates a more scalable review model** where experts validate, refine, or challenge trends.
- **Accelerate engagement with business units** with early warning signals and discussion-ready trends.
- **Strengthens foresight governance** by making quality criteria, audit logic, and evidence standards more explicit and repeatable.

LIMITATIONS

- **Trend phrasing remains a persistent weakness**, risking outputs that are evidence-linked but still difficult for business users to interpret.
- **One articulation logic does not fit all trend types**, especially when applying the same writing frame across different PESTLE domains.
- **Human oversight is non-negotiable** for selecting what is credible, relevant, and strategically meaningful.
- **Long, mixed prompts increase drift risk**, reducing control over articulation, reasoning, and evidence handling.

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

CROSS IMPACT

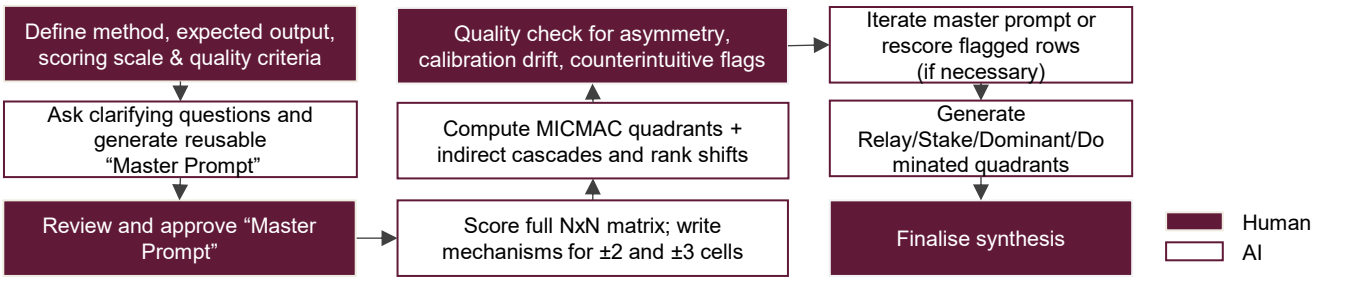
Claude | OUTPUT

GenAI-augmented MICMAC scored an **18x18 cross-impact matrix**, 306 directed pairs and articulated **60 sector-specific causal mechanisms**. The pilot included **indirect-effect cascade analysis**, surfacing rank shifts of up to 11 positions. **AI delivered the mechanical breadth**; scoring calibration, quadrant interpretation, and **validation remained human**.

KEY INSIGHTS

- **10x less times spent**; SME effort down from ~8 person-days to ~1 analyst-day for 306 cells.
- **80% pairs** had **asymmetric scoring** (differed in both directions, method requirement)
- AI made writing 60 evidence-grounded causal mechanisms feasible.
- Counterintuitive findings are sparse without prompting.
- **Quadrant interpretation remains human work**.
- Mechanism quality is bounded by trend-description specificity. **Generic trends produce generic mechanisms** regardless of prompt sophistication.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+3	~85% reduction in analyst+SME effort. 306 cells and 60 causal mechanisms produced in ~1 analyst-day vs. estimated 7–10 person-days for a manual multi-expert workshop equivalent.
Throughput time	+4	Full N×N matrix with written mechanisms and indirect cascades completed in a single working day
Reliability	+2	Replicable when the master prompt codifies scoring scale, asymmetry rule, domain context; calibration drift between early and late rows requires explicit anchoring and spot-checks.
Analytical breadth	+4	NxN completeness with 60 written mechanisms and indirect effect cascade analysis. Manual workshops almost never achieve this depth.
Credibility	-1	Mechanisms are coherent and sector-grounded but rest on AI extrapolation. Score values themselves carry judgment risk and require expert validation for high-stakes pairs.
Usability for humans	0	Multi-sheet excel output is structured, traceable; quadrant labels still require human interpretation layer to translate into strategic action.

IMPLICATIONS

- **MICMAC analysis becomes viable for routine cycles**.
- Indirect-cascade analysis (M^2, M^3) too **shifts from optional to default**.
- **High token usage** for finding relevant public and confidential data for triangulation.
- **The analyst role shifts** to scoring auditor and interpretation (checking calibration, asymmetry, counterintuitive flags, and analysing quadrants).

LIMITATIONS

- Input quality limits output quality.
- AI **scoring is a function of triangulation** of data. **Expert validation** of ±3 scored cells is **essential**.
- **AI defaults toward the canonical narrative.** Counterintuitive findings emerge only when prompted.
- Quadrant labels can be over-trusted. The analyst owns the "so what".
- **Calibration drift is hard to detect** from output alone.

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

IMPACT UNCERTAINTY

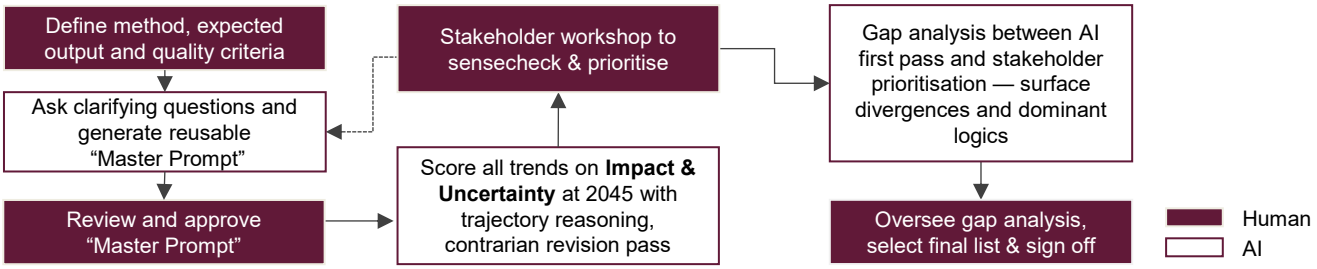
ChatGPT Deep Search | Claude | OUTPUT

GenAI-supported impact & uncertainty assessment **combined AI scoring and human validation** from academic and program directors. AI **accelerated first-pass reasoning**, generated assumptions, and **surfaced divergences**, while **human experts** retained **responsibility** for interpretation, **strategic judgement**, and final prioritisation of the **uncertainty landscape**.

KEY INSIGHTS

- Assessment of **57 trends completed** about **2x faster** without a multi-stakeholder session
- A **forced contrarian-revision pass** (optimism /recency) revealed **AI's default biases**.
- The **two-phase workflow** (AI/Human/AI) was built to **counter contextual bias** for both.
- **Reliability degrades** when **too many trends** are **scored in one pass**. 20-trend batches preserved reasoning depth; larger batches flattened it
- Without the anti-flattening discipline, **uncertainty ratings collapse**, and the grid loses differentiation.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+2	1.5 days combining one analyst and one consultant, with consultant time reserved for challenging dominant logics and validating AI reasoning.
Throughput time	+3	Full impact–uncertainty assessment of the trend set completed in 1.5 days, compared to typical multi-session stakeholder workshops.
Reliability	+2	Well-anchored prompts produce consistent, structured logic framing across trends; reliability degrades when too many trends are batched in a single pass.
Analytical breadth	0	Considers multiple trajectories, extrapolates from trend cards; broader system-level contextualisation remains limited.
Credibility	+1	Projections name explicit mechanisms. AI flags its own least-confident calls; human validation of underlying assumptions remains necessary.
Usability for humans	+2	Color-coded grid and summarised logic framings direct human attention to trends most needing challenge; printable logic summaries support workshop design and scenario dev.

IMPLICATIONS

- **Makes early-stage prioritisation faster,** helping narrow the field before scenario building, workshop design, or executive discussion.
- **Reveals hidden assumptions** in how the organisation thinks about the trend developments.
- **Improves workshop efficiency** by shifting human effort to judgment.
- **Supports portfolio-level sensemaking** across trends and relevant business units.

LIMITATIONS

- **Uncertainty is context-dependent,** and AI struggles to assess trends as a part of a dynamic system.
- **Dominant logics inherited from training data** can over-rank narratively rich trends.
- **Quantification can create false precision** and be treated as an objective measurement.
- **Human validation is non-negotiable** for challenging assumptions, catching inherited biases, and ensuring strategic relevance of the shortlist.

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

SYSTEMS DYNAMICS ANALYSIS

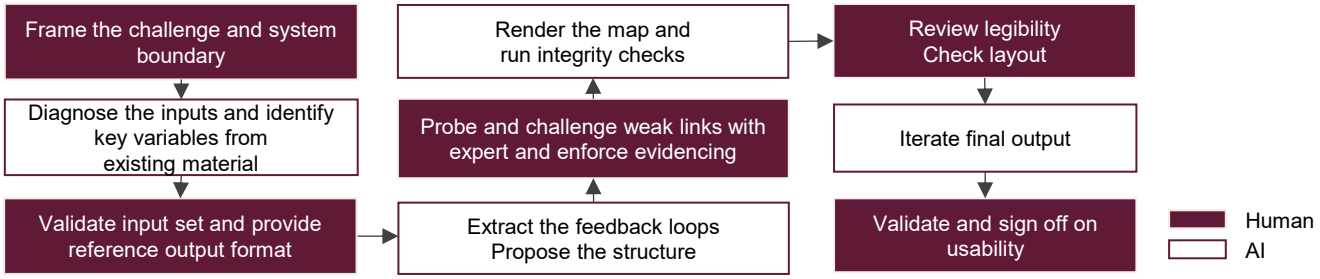
ChatGPT | Claude | OUTPUT

This AI-augmented method built on cross-impact and impact-uncertainty analysis to **map how key forces of the system interacts**. **AI established causal links**, **identified self-reinforcing loops**, and weighted their activation across scenarios **in an interactive system map**. Human judgment framed the system architecture, reduced it to a readable level of abstraction, and flagged where interpretation and SME validation were needed.

KEY INSIGHTS

- **System maps** become living, **queryable tools** rather than static deliverables.
- The functionality ceiling is high, but content validation remains the bottleneck.
- AI makes every link traceable, yet **credibility needs a human** to explain variable's role in the system.
- **At least one expert pass is recommended** as it reduces iteration.
- The method runs **7x faster** than human teams only
- Starting with a set format with **worked examples** of maps flattens the learning curve, **potentially halving iterations**.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+2	An analyst is able to model the systems map with AI tools; however, one expert validation pass is still required.
Throughput time	+2	The final interactive map took about 4 days of analyst time, compared with a human baseline of roughly 15 days with a team of 2-3 experts and a specialised mapping tool.
Reliability	-2	Reliability falls as system scope and ambiguity rise and prompts don't transfer across contexts; though tightly framed systems or engineered systems, i.e., airports fare better.
Analytical breadth	+3	The final output integrated relational data of 13 synthesised drivers' cross-impact and impact-uncertainty analysis (200+ datapoints) in one system.
Credibility	-1	Traceability to research is high with AI, but it is challenging to trust as it often creates new lexicon.
Usability for humans	+2	Human intervention is necessary for maintaining human comprehensibility. AI generates bespoke, interactive, and more flexible system maps on demand.

IMPLICATIONS

- With AI building maps, the **key challenge** shifts to teams allocating time & **upskilling analysts for sensemaking**.
- Interactive maps can become **living tools for decision-makers.**
- **For bounded**, engineered **systems** such as operations or supply chains, the **method could be standardised**.
- **For markets** and industry futures, expect to run **bespoke outputs** and treat them **as hypotheses**.
- Teams should curate a library of worked example maps, which transfer across projects better than prompts.

LIMITATIONS

- Given the full research corpus, AI mixes levels of detail and can't converge without a human imposing the structure.
- Prompts built for one system architecture don't carry over to another domain; only best practices do.
- Labels and terms are hard to understandwithout human rework.
- Credibility depends on the quality of the inputs, and weaknesses there carry through.

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

FUTURES WHEEL

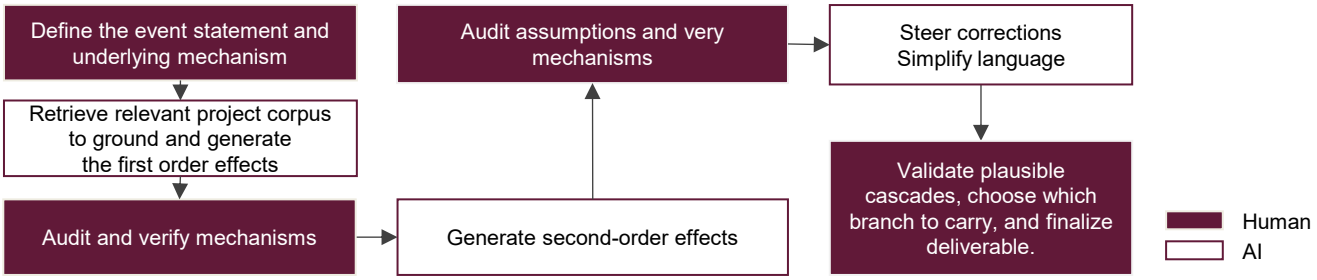
Claude | OUTPUT

The futures wheel maps the **cascading consequences of (uncertain, what-if) events** through first- and second-order effects. AI generated the consequence cascade at speed **grounded in mechanisms** for **the key actors of the ecosystem**. Human judgment remained essential for framing the event, deciding which branches were plausible, and preserving the divergent sense-making that a solo run otherwise loses.

KEY INSIGHTS

- **2x less effort** than human only.
- The **corpus bounds output quality**.
- (When running it in the same context window) AI defaults to one coherent, **plausible cascade**.
- Low-probability, high-impact counter-branches required **deliberate iterative-prompting**.
- **Structuring** this method by stakeholder keeps the output MECE and comparable, but **trades creativity** when done solely with AI.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	0	A single futures wheel is a low-resource exercise to begin with. AI saved little absolute resource because there was little to save.
Throughput time	+2	Fast iteration is the real gain as articulation and final outputs as image or slide can be produced in one go.
Reliability	0	High human intervention throughout was needed to frame uncertain event, catching the market-structure/business-model overlap, and counter-branches.
Analytical breadth	+1	A divergent thinking exercise, not an analytical one. The analytical breadth sits in the cascade mechanisms.
Credibility	+1	Derives almost entirely from linking pre-built trends and cross impact; the cascades themselves are unevidenced plausibility.
Usability for humans	+2	Tables and node labels were layout- and diagram-ready and iterated cleanly into the provided format.

IMPLICATIONS

- **With AI**, one may run every weak signal and "what-if" from the horizon scan, moving **coverage of the uncertainty space from sampled to near-exhaustive**.
- The method is better served by AI as **a second-pass challenger** than as the primary generator.
- AI **adds more value** to stress-testing and **red-teaming a human-built wheel** than building it from scratch.
- **Consequence maps** can **become living artefacts** instead of one-off outputs.
- An org's grounded **knowledge hub becomes high-leverage**. As the **quality of outputs rises** with the quality and relevance of the data corpus.

LIMITATIONS

- **Fluency hides** the **difference** between grounded first-order from **assumption heavy** second-order **effects**.
- AI **defaults to the plausible-canonical cascade**; the high-impact counter-branches **require explicit micro-iterative prompting**.
- Run almost entirely on AI yields a coherent but single-perspective map.

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

SCENARIO ANALYSIS & NARRATIVE

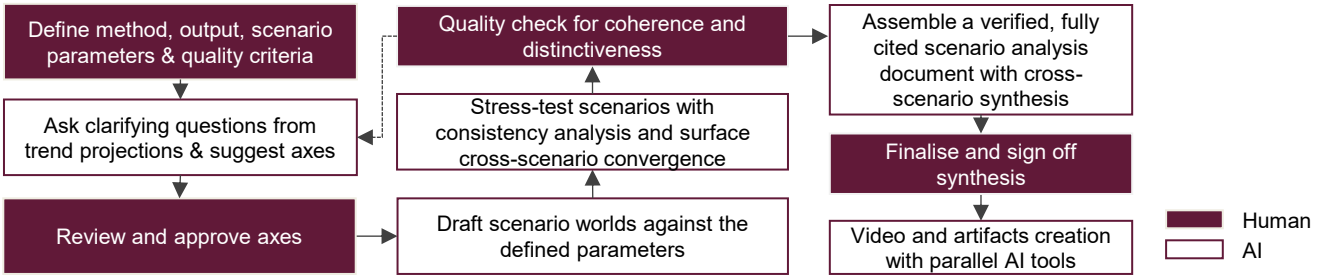
ChatGPT | Claude | OUTPUT

This AI-augmented method is built on trend projections and MICMAC cross-impact analysis to frame a 2x2 axes. The **pilot included** a **cross-scenario convergence pass** and a **consistency analysis** for robustness. AI further supported **drafting 4 scenario narratives** consisting of personas, trajectories, indicators, baselines, etc., and **pushed for creativity** in scenario naming, persona construction and narrative voice.

KEY INSIGHTS

- **~7x productivity gain** and **8x faster narrative drafting** with human-AI workflow.
- AI added **speed and accuracy** to cross-scenario **convergence and consistency analysis.**
- **Opportunity** to **imagine new engagement modes** with scenario content.
- Axis framing and **scenario validation** must be **expert-led**.
- Multiple passes are required as **AI defaults to plausible-canonical futures** (more than in earlier analytical methods)
- **Structure bounds AI creativity** but enforces consistency.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+3	Generated 4 scenarios (~5,300 words) using trend projections and cross-impact outputs, reducing first-draft effort. The savings increase when led by senior foresight architect.
Throughput time	+4	Scenarios across the full parameter set drafted in 3 days versus a typical 14-day sprint with multi-workshop scenario cycle. Long draft reviews and narrative steers adds further time.
Reliability	+2	Structural reliability is high; templatized drafts with 100% consistency across scenarios, reproducibly. However, multiple passes are required to reduce inconsistencies.
Analytical breadth	+3	Full 2×2 with parameter depth, 4 personas, ~20 representative indicator baselines, trend projections and cross-scenario synthesis with relevant discussion starters.
Credibility	+1	Cross references trends and hyperlinks some grounded examples (e.g. a certain company's 2045 trajectory within a scenario).
Usability for humans	+2	First pass and final drafts for customisable for easier readings. With parallel AI tools, further tailored engagement with scenarios are possible.

IMPLICATIONS

- **Short creation cycles** allow for nuanced and tailored scenarios to workshop goals and decision outcomes.
- **Multi-AI tools** could be used to **visualise and interact** with the content **beyond the traditional** format.
- **Strategy teams** without dedicated foresight specialists **can leverage scenarios** (with one senior interpreter).
- Organisations must **invest in individual foresight training** to engage in AI workflow and, more crucially, to **engage with uncertainty** and facilitate discussions.

LIMITATIONS

- **Treating AI** as an **autonomous** scenario producer **loses** both quality and **developmental value**.
- **AI defaults to specificity** (specific actors, years, quantities), resulting in conventional scenarios.
- **Scenarios inherit** structural **weakness from the upstream** outputs (e.g., trends phrased as outcomes rather than driving forces)
- **Long sessions degrade quality** and increase token usage as inconsistencies, contradictions, and dead ends get carried forward into later outputs.

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

SCENARIO QUANTIFICATION

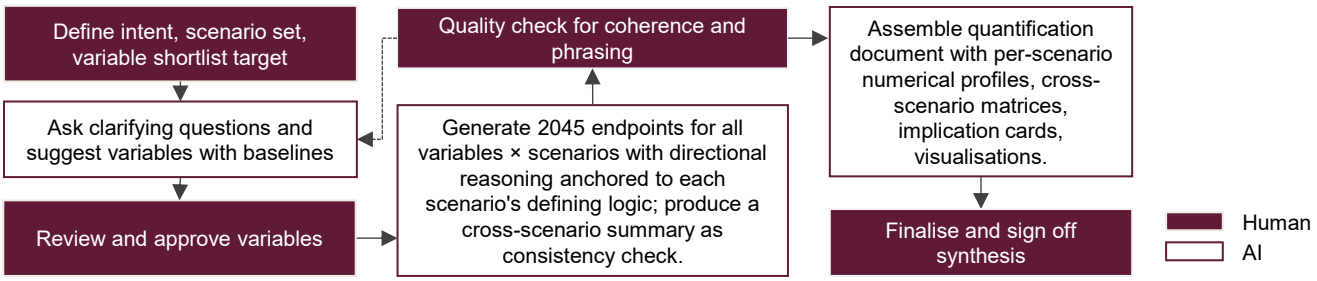
ChatGPT | Claude | OUTPUT

Scenario quantification translates qualitative scenarios into per-variable, per-scenario numerical profiles. AI **generated a variable shortlist** with cited baselines and **scenario-conditional 2045 projections** with **directional reasoning**. **Human judgment** set the variable scope, signed off on the shortlist, **owned natural ceilings per variable**, and held the comparison-not-prediction discipline against numerical drift.

KEY INSIGHTS

- **AI black box** binds horizon depth. Past 2035, endpoints require human-set ceilings.
- **Baseline** anchors AI and **prevents** it from **projecting further than ± 10%** of the baseline in all scenarios.
- **5x faster processing**, though review and validation reduce the net saving.
- Anglo-American framing dominates the baseline.
- **Numerical specificity** invites readers to treat **ranges as forecasts.**

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+2	Review and validation burden is heavy, requires analyst and consultant iterations which erodes the net resource saving.
Throughput time	+1	Endpoint estimation for 21 variables against 4 scenario logic is the largest saving. Further time is spent in validating assumptions.
Reliability	0	Direction holds across the 84 cells; magnitude drifts toward baseline ±10% without named anchors. Past 2035 reliability degrades sharply.
Analytical breadth	+3	Identified cross scenario variables along with cited baselines. 21 variables across demand, market, and supply enabler signals.
Credibility	+1	2025 baselines cited per variable with reliability tiers; 2035 built on CAGR ranges while 2045 endpoints are scenario-conditional reasoning outputs.
Usability for humans	+2	Scenario-coloured headers, comparable variable visuals, and intuitive metrics like TAM make cross-scenario comparison direct

IMPLICATIONS

- **Short creation cycles** allow for tailored scenario projections that enrich discussion.
- Scenario quantification becomes **viable for routine portfolio cycles**.
- **Strategy teams** without dedicated foresight specialists **can leverage scenarios** (with one senior interpreter).
- Organisations must **invest in individual foresight training** to **engage with uncertainty** and facilitate discussions.
- **Living artefacts** in JSON or HTML open up **scenario outputs as queryable resources.**

LIMITATIONS

- **AI's biases surface** (like stronger Anglo-American framing), resulting in generic projections & baselines.
- Without explicit anchors, the **outputs suffer from magnitude drift**.
- Analyst must be able to understand nuances to **guide "Natural ceiling" for each variable**, making 2045 projections read as measurements.
- Numerical specificity invites AI to treat it as a forecast.

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

FUTURE MARKETS

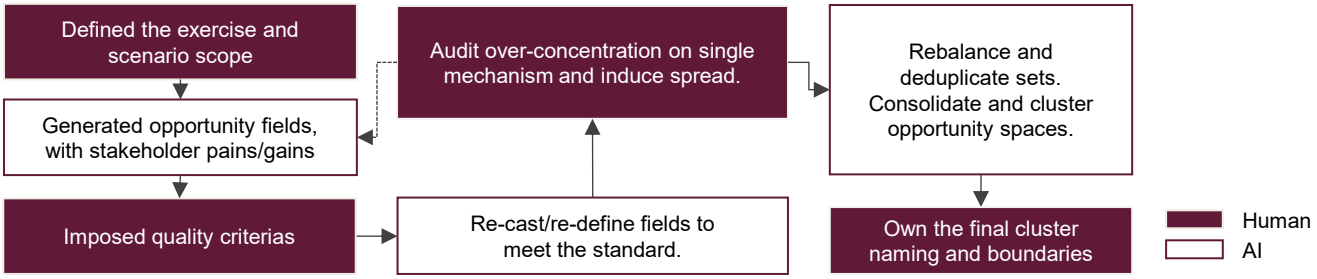
Copilot | ChatGPT | Claude | OUTPUT

GenAI-augmented future-market definition **leverages scenario tensions** for a structured **set of candidate opportunity spaces** and clusters them into coherent strategic groups. AI generated and described the candidates; **human judgment imposes** legibility and **diversity standards**, deduplicates, and **owns the cluster boundaries**.

KEY INSIGHTS

- Market descriptions default to high level abstraction.
- **5x faster processing**; net saving stays modest after ~5 curation rounds
- Without scenario anchors, the candidates drift to generic futures.
- Recognising shared logic has an analytical value of consolidating and clustering fields.
- AI reliably surfaces leverage and assets playing different roles across scenarios.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+1	Net saving is modest as the defensible set emerged after ~5 human curation rounds (legibility, diversity, deduplication).
Throughput time	+1	Time-to-defensible field set, and clusters ran across 4 scenarios vs. a typical multi-workshop market-definition cycle, albeit several iteration rounds. (N-1, novelty)
Reliability	-1	The candidate set was unreliable, i.e., vague articulation and single-mechanism concentration until explicit standards were imposed.
Analytical breadth	+1	Covered 4 scenarios and 8 stakeholders with cross-scenario robustness, though breadth only appeared once the diversity check was passed.
Credibility	0	Descriptions were anchored to scenario logic and client strategy, but a future-market description is a structured hypothesis, not a validated finding.
Usability for humans	0	The final clustered, investor-legible field set was directly workshop-usable. However, only after the human imposed structure and boundary controls.

IMPLICATIONS

- **Widens the search space** as AI lowers the cost of describing fringe and long-tail future markets.
- **Market definition** becomes a divergence step **run at portfolio scale**; applying stage gate discipline to the unblocked ideation capacity.
- The **human skill expands** from **imagining future markets** to also **quality-gating** them with AI.

LIMITATIONS

- The **candidate set concentrated** on the scenario's **dominant mechanism** and had to be forced apart into distinct value layers.
- Apparent breadth was superficial before curation. Multiple fields restated similar underlying play under different labels, and deduplication was a human-prompted step.
- **Cluster boundaries** are human judgment calls and **require human oversight and ownership**.

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

MARKET SIZING

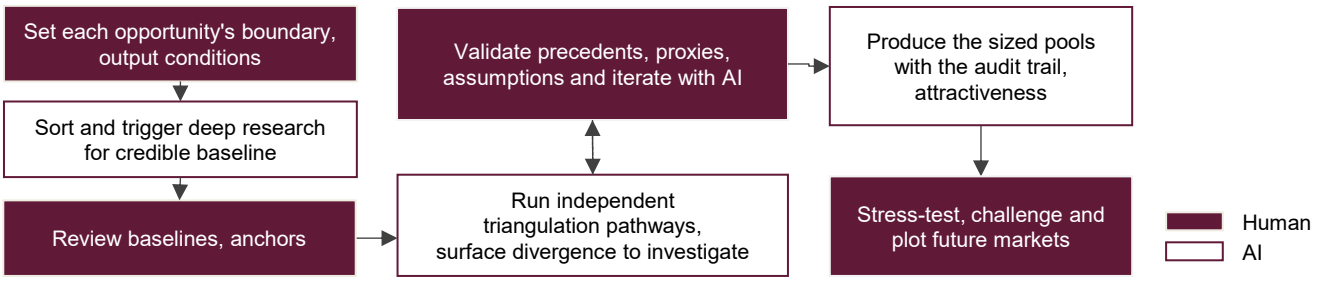
Gemini | ChatGPT | Claude | OUTPUT

This GenAI-augmented method, **through triangulation**, **estimates the Total Addressable Market** of the future opportunity spaces. **AI** was allowed to **set the boundary**, cite the **current baseline**, and **triangulate** the future **top-down (supply) and bottom-up (demand)** until the two routes reconcile. It performed best when the proxies were reviewed and steered in tandem, with a human.

KEY INSIGHTS

- **Value increases at the portfolio level** and can be re-triggered as assumptions change.
- **6x faster search-cite-triangulate loop.**
- **Multiple triangulation pathways**, top-down market-share, bottom-up demand units, analogous market, and proxy are further value additions.
- Separates "what the market could be" from "what we assume about the future".
- **AI produces** a plausible **sizing fast**, building the **audit trail stay human-paced**.
- AI sizing is bounded by baseline availability; most **novel streams require more human steer**.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+2	The search-cite-triangulate loop was fast, but boundary-setting and demanding the audit trail kept the analyst heavily in the loop. Multiple triangulation pathways is value adding.
Throughput time	+2	Reaching a trustworthy sizing needed slow steps including deep-research detour and human intervention for unsizable streams.
Reliability	-2	AI defaulted to defensible not verifiable conclusions, often resorting to complex formulas and excel outputs making it particular challenging to validate assumptions and approach.
Analytical breadth	+3	After several steers, the sizing provided comparable coverage of opportunity space by pooling 3-4 independent ways across 2030 and 2045 horizon.
Credibility	+1	Current-size baselines were web-cited, but weak choice of proxies, precedents and placeholder anchors reduced credibility.
Usability for humans	0	The base-evidence + proxy + formula structure is repeatable once validated. The outputs need careful human framing and translation before use.

IMPLICATIONS

- **Lowers** the **cost of sizing** entire **portfolios**, changing which opportunities get a number at all.
- **Enables leadership** to compare portfolio-level prizes and **pick the mix** that **maximises across scenarios**.
- AI runs the search-cite-triangulate loop, **making sizing a living, re-runnable artefact**.
- Can be **re-triggered** as gaps fill or **assumption changes**, rather than re-commissioned (provided assumptions and baselines are validated)

LIMITATIONS

- **AI defaults to defensible conclusions**, not verifiable workings.
- 2045 point estimates read as false precision; this **method is best run for short/medium-term futures**.
- A **mix of LLMs** was **required** to source credible baselines **for the most novel fields**.
- Opportunity boundary needs explicit setting for sizing the relevant market.

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

FUTURES WORKSHOP

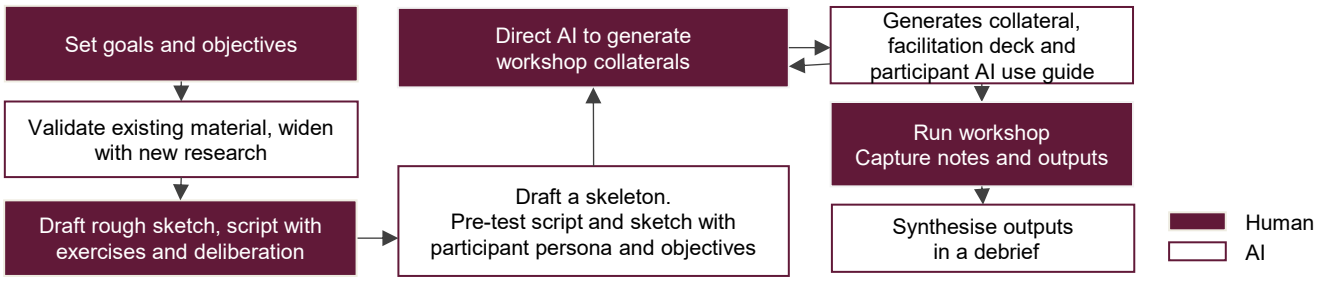
Gemini | ChatGPT | Claude | OUTPUT

A futures workshop brings stakeholder groups together to interact with plausible futures, surface and test assumptions, and converge on priorities. **AI supported scoping, research**, and the **co-building of workshop materials** like pre-reads, video artefacts and interactive content like polls and discussion questions. Post-workshop, AI supported debrief synthesis. Objective setting, conceptualisation, and facilitation stayed human.

KEY INSIGHTS

- AI co-produced workshop stimulus material, **cutting prep time by 60%.**
- **AI** stood in **as participants to pre-test the script**, exposing weak framing and unclear instructions in advance.
- AI sped up referencing the futures work, drafting facilitation notes and backup material to support workshop exercises.
- **Participants using AI** with guiding questions during the workshop **moved faster but not significantly better** through creative exercises.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+1	Content building with AI took fewer analyst resources. The facilitator stays more involved than AI throughout, so the savings across the whole workshop are smaller.
Throughput time	+2	Content prep was 60% faster, and workshop exercises with AI ran faster in the room without impacting deliberation.
Reliability	-1	Output quality swings with the facilitator's vision, since AI drifts toward abstract ideas and voluminous output. Codifying parts of the preparation showed marginal gains.
Analytical breadth	+2	AI widened the pool of futures and acted as a reliable data analyst. Much of the rest was abstract until the facilitator tested it for relevance.
Credibility	0	The final material was well received by participants. They found the dilemmas realistic and relevant. This came from independently checking every estimate and inference.
Usability for humans	0	Participant AI use sped up exercises and outputs. However, a lack of context from the participants limited its effectiveness.

IMPLICATIONS

- A **single facilitator can produce stronger material** in house, including bespoke video, posters and polls, shifting budget from production to concept design and validation.
- Facilitators can bring partly built outputs from futures material, leaving **participants to develop them from their own vantage point in the organisation.**
- Once codified, the workshop can be re-versioned cheaply for new audiences, which makes **cascade and follow-on formats viable**.

LIMITATIONS

- **AI creativity is passable but abstract**, so contextual relevance must come from the facilitator and participants.
- Left to choose, **AI often over-engineers**, so the facilitator must set each concept, and AI produces it.
- Other limitations of AI in research apply.

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

Y-MODEL

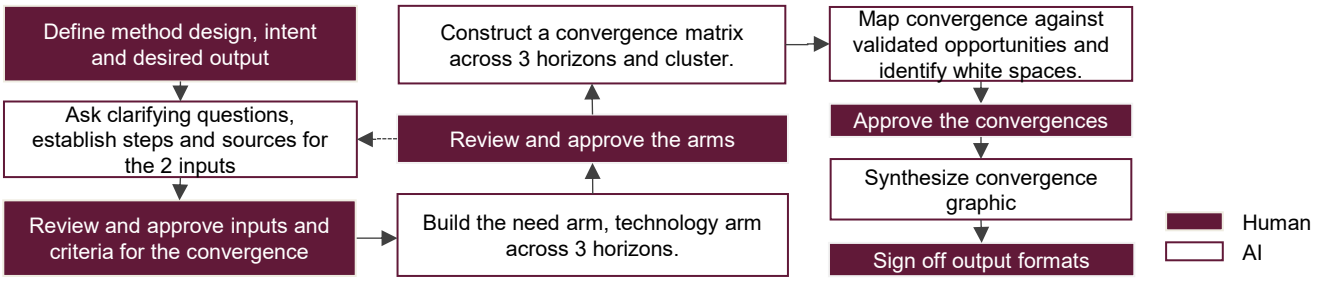
ChatGPT | Claude | OUTPUT

The AI-augmented method **independently built a** future demand arm, a technology arm, and an innovation arm, then **converged** them to back track what becomes buildable when. Further, AI **scored the convergence** cells **across 3 horizons**, and located pre-set opportunity clusters on a timeline. Human judgment reviewed scope creeps, cluster logics and convergence scores.

KEY INSIGHTS

- TRL-style indicators carried the positioning and **strong reasoning**.
- AI reasoned better about mid-term futures (5-10 years) than long-term futures (15+ years).
- **Scope drift** towards products/business models is highly likely unless explicitly flagged.
- **3× faster two-arm model build.**
- Future needs and emerging technologies require human probing.
- Scanning innovation and business-model enablers surfaced material that a technology-only scan would not.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+1	Developing the brief needed consultant effort. Analytically heavy tasks like scanning future needs, technology maturity, innovations and business models was done independently.
Throughput time	+2	Full two-arm model and across a small number of sessions.
Reliability	+1	Stage gated, analytical method that could be rerun for various topics.
Analytical breadth	+2	Convergence based on gated threshold values for needs and technologies. Limited to mid term horizons such as 2035. Probablistic convergences after that.
Credibility	0	Suggests future for convergences but challenging to verify, lacking precedence.
Usability for humans	+2	Produced a multi-tabl spreasheet with convergence of the Y-model. Produced an intuitive 3 horizon bubble map graphic.

IMPLICATIONS

- Capability roadmapping and future-back thinking become achievable on demand.
- The method **can be run by R&D** / tech-scouting teams.
- **Access to high-quality** technology **data** will **add credibility** to the output.
- **Adding stage gate** to the method's workflow would **make it agent-ready**.

LIMITATIONS

- A senior industry **expert validation** is **recommended**.
- **Timing and maturity-lens** placements are AI **extrapolations** from **LLM trained data**. Unless explicitly provided.
- The multi-tab Excel output is overwhelming to review without curation.

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

STARTUP SCANNING

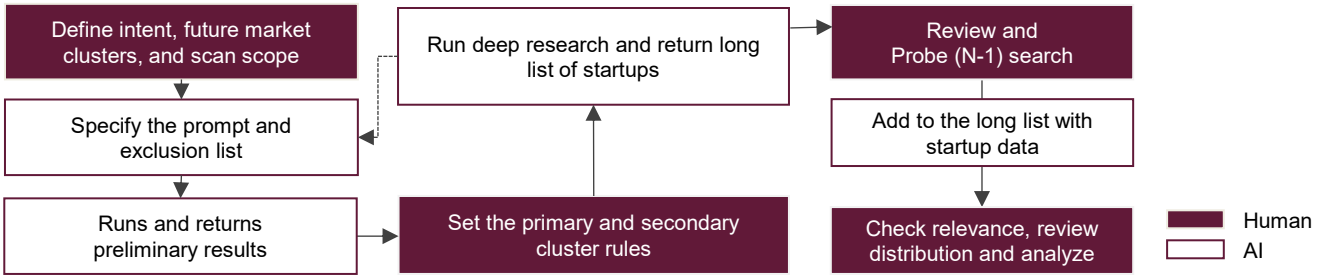
ChatGPT | Claude | OUTPUT

GenAI-augmented startup scanning performed **scanning and light analysis** of startups clustered by **future markets**, using prior foresight-method outputs as its foundational scope. AI scaled the retrieval, first-pass structuring and a summary graphic; **human judgment steers the scope**, **probes the non-obvious** N-1 searches, and **checks relevance**.

KEY INSIGHTS

- **6x faster scanning** and data structuring.
- AI **self-scoping skews tech-heavy**.
- The **scan** crowded into the technology domain and **reproduced what diligent desk research** would find.
- Volume causes review fatigue, and **output completeness cannot be assumed**.
- Humans remain necessary to reason and probe the N-1 searches.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+1	Scanned and structured 117 entities across 5 passes, but content volume created a review burden and needed analyst intervention for useful qualification.
Throughput time	+2	Per-pass turnaround was fast, but failed runs and micro-prompting and reviewing long excel data sheets added time and cycles.
Reliability	0	Matched a human on public information with no new insight; sources skewed to high-SEO and AI-first-SEO content, and 2 runs returned the wrong artefact before a usable pass.
Analytical breadth	-1	AI self-scoping skewed tech-heavy and thin on non-obvious domains; gains were realized after human intervening and reframing the search.
Credibility	+1	Every entity carries a working, opened source link with unverified entities flagged, but coverage skews to what ranks online and this pilot was limited to public information.
Usability for humans	0	Final workbook and cluster graphic are workshop-ready, but content volume drove review fatigue and the intended scope was not fully achieved.

IMPLICATIONS

- With a tightly qualified scope and access to quality datasets, the method could run largely independently with AI, reserving humans for reasoning and probing non-obvious threads.
- **Existing platforms** are likely to build these capabilities natively or expose them via API.
- **Potential** exists to **surface non-obvious startups**, but only once the dependence on high-SEO online data is broken with structured sources.

LIMITATIONS

- Rising CAPTCHA and **anti-crawling measures** will further **reduce reliability** as agent crawling is curbed.
- Value-add is **limited for non-obvious domains**, where the signal is poorly represented online.
- Content **volume cannot** be assumed for **completeness**.

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

IDEA & CONCEPT DEVELOPMENT

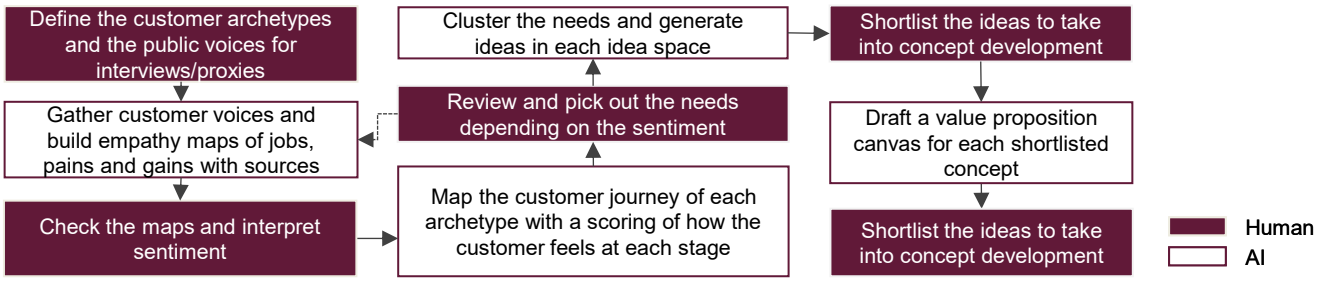
Claude | OUTPUT

For this method AI **built empathy maps** of pains, gains and jobs-to-be-done for 4 **customer archetype, validated against public customer voices** (podcasts, first-person articles) used as proxies for interviews. AI then mapped the customer journey, played archetypes across scenarios, and **clustered needs** to locate idea spaces. Human judgment placed evidence in journey context, interpreted sentiment, shortlisted and built out the concepts.

KEY INSIGHTS

- **AI works as a research assistant**, not the empathiser, gathering customer voices at scale.
- **3x faster** ideation and **5x faster** concept development
- AI-built archetypes **bring unusual vocabulary**, **effectively dehumanizing** the empathy map.
- **Outsourcing** all analysis **weakens** human intuition and **ownership**.
- Placing **customer needs stays human**, since AI senses feeling but not context.
- The **value** lies in a **systematic base** for **generating ideas**, not necessarily for producing better or more defensible ones.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	0	Design-centric work leans heavily on human involvement for contextual understanding and interpretation. AI acts as companion and reduces the leg work of thematic clustering.
Throughput time	0	About 5 days end-to-end including iteration, comparable to a standard 2-2.5 week ideation sprints.
Reliability	0	Using podcasts as a proxy for interviews is now an established process and repeatable to cluster level, but AI adds no reliability over a human.
Analytical breadth	+2	Screened 15 podcasts; the risk is AI merging several sources into composite statements.
Credibility	-1	Findings are traceable to sources, if human team is not involved, they are unable to judge the context or sign off.
Usability for humans	-1	Scores, curves and clusters are clear, but codifications gets ambiguous and language human wouldn't use.

IMPLICATIONS

- Expect a better **fit for digital services**. Where behavioural data such as heatmaps or usage logs exists.
- Teams may **build customer archetype clone agents** that sharpen with every round of new evidence.
- Teams may also build **synthetic personas to introduce dissonance,** test it as hypothesis with real users.
- The ideation team must be close to the raw material. And **budget time for human sensemaking**.
- Use AI to **extend** research sampling and **evidence base** for focus groups **instead of replacing the touchpoints**.

LIMITATIONS

- AI often mis-places sentiments along the journey.
- Codified factors are ambiguous and needs human intervention for interpretation.
- Having AI as the expert often creates a disconnect with the ownership for the analyst.

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

FUTURE USE CASES

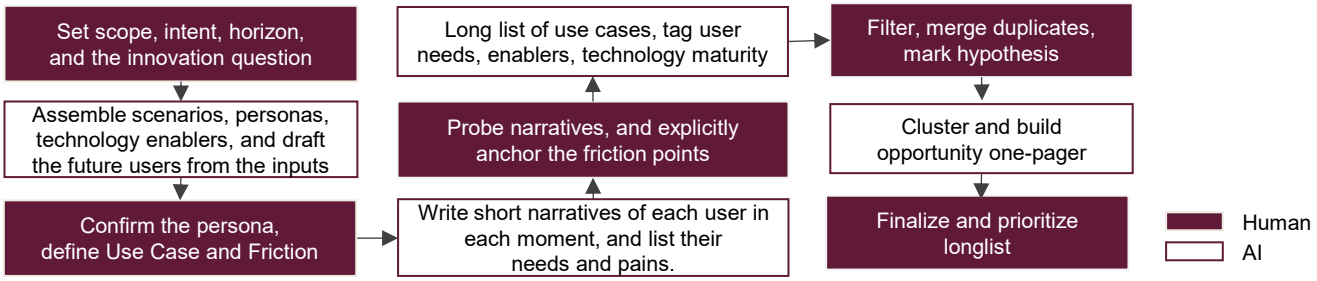
Claude | OUTPUT

This method builds a long list of opportunities from 3 upstream inputs: **future users with their pains and gains** from empathy mapping, **need and enabler matches** over time from the Y-model, and **emerging offers from startup scanning**. Each entry is a situation of use at the horizon. AI combines these at breadth. The human pushes for breadth and removes weak entries.

KEY INSIGHTS

- **Method sped up by 5x.**
- AI works as a **narrative engine**, matching moments of use and drafting almost instantly.
- **Use cases without precedent are hypotheses**. Extrapolating more than 10 y with AI often becomes challenging for humans to review.
- Key strengths included **tying each use case to its key enabler** and maturity over horizons.
- The human must set what counts as a use case before extraction starts.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+2	Reduces the effort of writing narratives and extracting cases, but curation, plausibility checks and user testing stay with the team.
Throughput time	+1	Narratives and extraction come fast, but time to a curated, tested list is set by human filtering.
Reliability	0	A fixed sequence of horizon, persona, narrative and extraction lets AI rerun consistently, but the cases depend on which users and moments the human picks, and it adds no reliability over a human.
Analytical breadth	+2	Covers more users, moments and scenarios than a workshop, with each case tied to an enabler, but it misses lived frictions and leans toward offers that already exist.
Credibility	-1	Each case traces to an enabler and its timing, but cases rest on imagined experience and stay hypotheses until tested with users.
Usability for humans	+1	The list feeds value proposition work once curated, but as delivered it sprawls and reads as coded analysis rather than something a team can pick from.

IMPLICATIONS

- The team's **measure of success** may shift from how many use cases it generates to **how well it filters them**.
- **Use cases become hypotheses to test** with real users, so primary research gains weight rather than losing it.
- The innovation team may need **new skills**: challenging AI outputs, spotting patterns across narratives, and running ethnographic research.
- The **narrative becomes a working tool** for extraction rather than a deliverable.

LIMITATIONS

- **AI lacks lived experience**, so its narratives miss the messy, **irrational frictions that drive real use cases**.
- **AI over-builds narratives**, so use cases may get buried in the story.
- AI leans toward use cases that may already exist, so extracted **use cases often restate the market**.
- AI returns more than asked, in coded tables, so the list overwhelms its readers until it is curated.

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

VALUE PROPOSITION

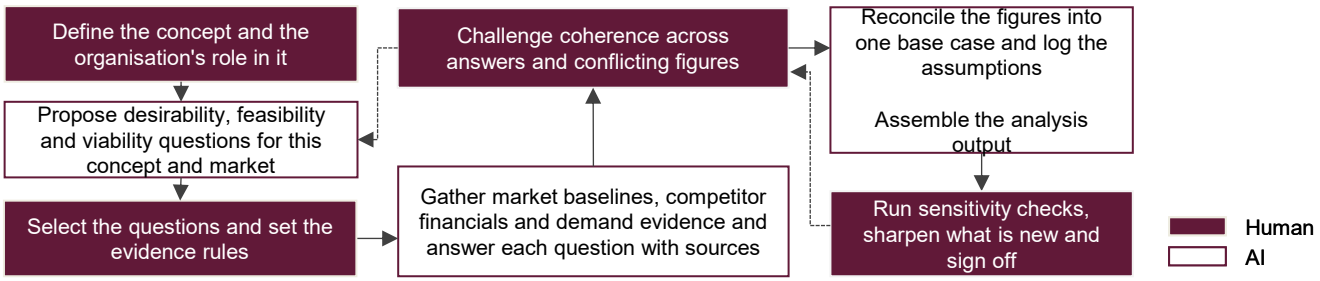
Copilot | Claude | OUTPUT

This AI-augmented method **developed a concept's value proposition** by building out its **desirability, feasibility and viability**. AI gathered market baselines and worked as a **co-pilot to the analyst**, finding, validating, calculating and projecting from a mix of proxies and real data points. **Human judgment owned the concept design**, stress-tested assumptions and reconciled conflicting figures.

KEY INSIGHTS

- **AI** works **as a co-pilot**, **not the owner**, collecting evidence and building DFV analysis.
- Frameworks with **guided questions** added to the Human-AI productivity.
- Key **strengths** included turning proxies and data into **estimates and projections**.
- Plausibility and sensitivity stress-tests stay human, since **AI lacks real-world constraints**.
- AI designs from precedent, so novelty, conviction and the **final narrative must be human owned.**

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+1	Reduces analysts and data-gathering effort, but not as owner and designer of the concept.
Throughput time	+1	Evidence is gathered and the concept written up faster; the claimed speed-up in prototyping was out of scope and not tested.
Reliability	+3	An established framework (Value Proposition Canvas) with guided prompts from analysts lets AI rerun the process consistently; output quality depended on the human lead.
Analytical breadth	+2	Strong evidence gathering across market baselines, competitor financials and customer demand signals.
Credibility	+3	Assumptions are derived and estimated with credible proxies as traceability added to the credibility.
Usability for humans	-2	AI's deck was more of a backup deck than a pitch. AI alone produced inconsistent figures and no ownership or narrative makes it harder for the pitch at this stage.

IMPLICATIONS

- Corporate teams should **assign a concept owner** before bringing AI into the process.
- **AI** is best deployed **as sparring partner**.
- **Review steps** should be built into the workflow to **catch inconsistent figures and false assumptions**.
- Novel concepts need deliberate human input, as **AI defaults to existing market precedent**.

LIMITATIONS

- There is no ownership or emotional narrative, so the output can't be pitched as is.
- AI anchors on all earlier anlysis, requiring repeated audits.
- Designs are drawn from precedence, which limits novelty.
- Future demand is proxied from today's customer voices.

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

MACTOR ANALYSIS

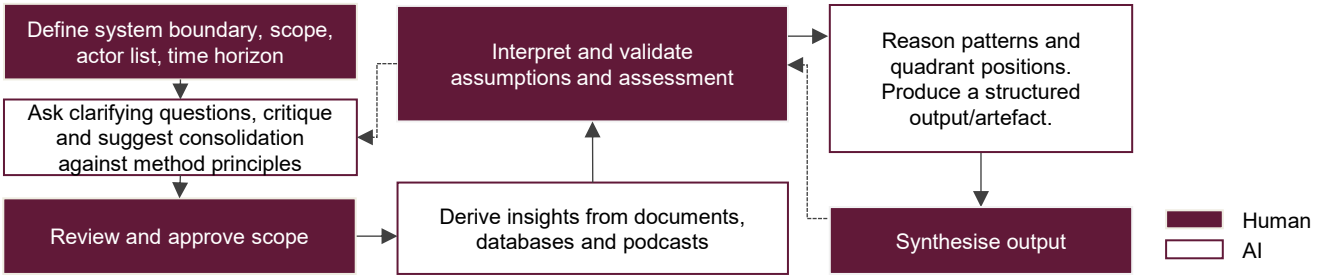
Gemini | Copilot | ChatGPT | Claude | OUTPUT

The method analysed key actors' direct & indirect influences across the shortlisted objectives. **AI added breadth in triangulation** with credible public sources, cross-impact and mechanisms. It built a **comprehensive understanding of actor** convergence and divergence over objectives, **providing insight into power structures**, **alliances, and conflict landscapes**. AI **also delivered** the **mechanical breadth**; scoring calibration, quadrant interpretation, and **validation remained human**.

KEY INSIGHTS

- **10x less** analyst effort.
- AI produces credible first-cut influence reasoning.
- Stakeholder-landscape mapping and **influence hypotheses become routine** working tools.
- **Coaching for complex methods** is **added high value benefit** from AI-human collaboration.
- AI **productively challenges** granularity, surfaces missing actors, and **pressure-tests** sub-grouping decisions.
- **Demonstrated capacity to reason** using institutional sources like EU policy databases and podcasts.
- Sensitivity testing is an organic by-product.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+2	~60% reduction in analyst effort: 1.5 days session vs estimated 3–5 analyst-days for traditional actor-list and objective scoping with client iteration.
Throughput time	+3	Single working session vs typical 1–2 weeks of client iteration cycles. Multi-modal synthesis is the highest-value capability.
Reliability	+1	Methodological rigour preserved. Required several revisions; aggressive consolidations needed human push back. Reproducible with opening prompt structure.
Analytical breadth	+3	Multi-source synthesis across briefing and data heavy documents. The analytical bottleneck of MACTOR remains untested in this pilot.
Credibility	+1	Grounded in methodology. Market examples confidently sourced and specifics noted with admitted uncertainty in places.
Usability for humans	+2	Final artefact structured for handoff, i.e., codes, strategic-interest descriptions, example organisations, granularity decisions, open items, candidate splits.

IMPLICATIONS

- **Makes systematic MACTOR analysis accessible** to smaller-sized teams.
- Methodological coaching creates a parallel value stream.
- The **bottleneck moves upstream** in setting system-boundary framing and quadrant validation.
- **Time saved** on the first draft can be **redeployed to insight refinement** and upward sharing.
- **"What good looks like" becomes infrastructure**, and practitioners investing in defining it get compounded returns.

LIMITATIONS

- **Calibration drift** across rated cells is **hard to detect** from output alone. **Output volume** can outpace an **analyst's cognitive capacity**.
- AI **substituting analyst iteration** for stakeholder confrontation **is a cost** in both legitimacy and **insight quality**.
- Output artefacts are structured text but visually inert; a **parallel visualisation toolchain is needed** for comprehensibility.

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

COMPETITOR ANALYSIS

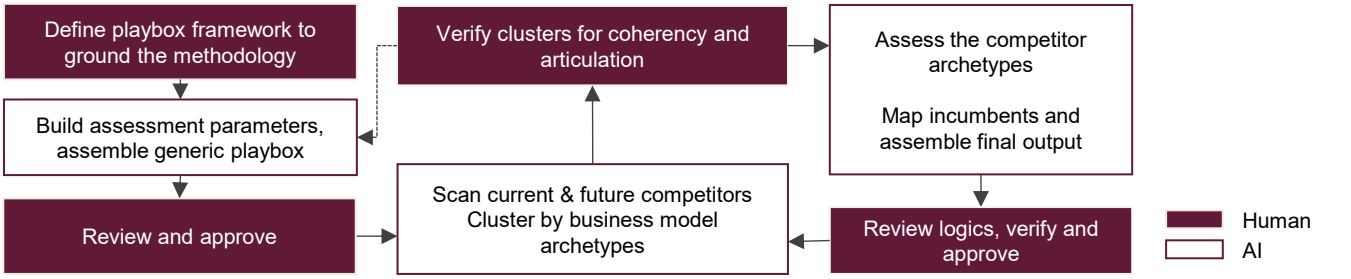
Gemini | ChatGPT | Claude | OUTPUT

This method included **scanning and light analysis** of **current and future competitors** clustered **as archetypes**. AI was instructed to **build the assessment parameters** and assemble them into a strategy playbox for comparative analysis. Human judgment verifies the parameters, generic strategic playbox, archetypes, and sense-checks competitor business-model logics.

KEY INSIGHTS

- **10x scanning speed** is the dominant value-add
- The **rating parameters** need **scoping with seniors** to treat the output as decision usable.
- Inserting **human verification** between frame, clusters, and final outputs **reduces drift**.
- AI **performed** more **reliably at the archetype level** than at the company level.
- Business-model **sense-making needs experienced eyes**; agents plus junior support cannot close the loop.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+1	Scanning identified as the dominant value-add. Senior professional surpervision required to instill trust and build decision ready output.
Throughput time	+2	Competitor models and pivots surfaced on demand and at pace.
Reliability	+2	Generally reliable and improved by stage gates; stronger at archetype level than company level.
Analytical breadth	+1	Surfaced a wide span of competitor models, options, and pivots. Business-model logics were not clear and precedence for rating needed deliberate micro-iterative prompting.
Credibility	-1	Missed key details about competitors at company level. AI filled gaps with trained data which needs individual verification for relevance.
Usability for humans	-1	Final output feeds strategy discussion well. But mid-method reviews are not verifable or usable. Often returns more parameters than asked for.

IMPLICATIONS

- Adds value for analysing both **current and future competitors**.
- **Enables periodic evaluation** relevant for strategy conversations.
- **Produces tailored competitor briefings** with initial analysis **for deep dive** with corporate venture, R&D and intelligence units.
- Further high-value **opportunity when paired** with **customer/product reviews and patent** analysis.

LIMITATIONS

- **At company level**, AI fills missing data with plausible detail that **passes casual reviews but not scrutiny**.
- Rising CAPTCHA and **anti-crawling measures** will further **reduce reliability** as agent crawling is curbed.
- Junior analysts may not reliably catch AI assessment.
- **Critical review** of archetypes and data sources are **non-negotiable**.

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

BUSINESS MODEL CANVAS

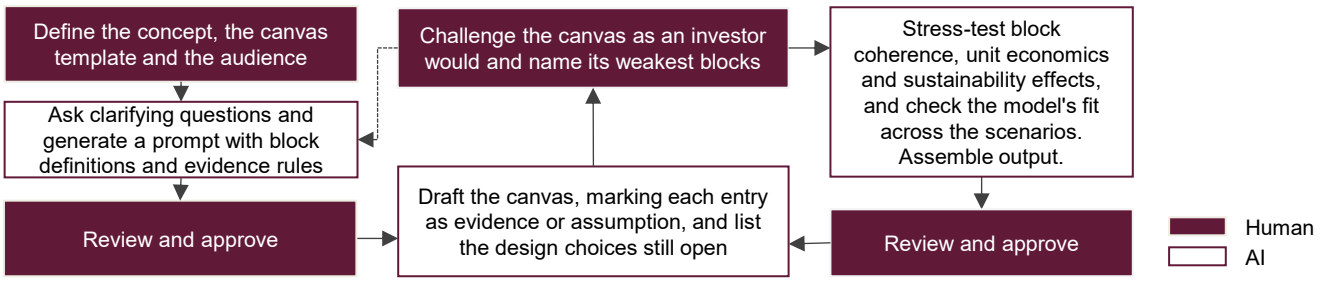
Claude | OUTPUT

This AI augmented method turns a **tested concept into the blueprint** an investor or leadership would back. AI filled the blocks of the canvas using existing knowledge of the **concept from previous methods** and **additional research**. Human judgment chose the template, **challenged the customer logic** and **owned the investment case** the canvas has to carry.

KEY INSIGHTS

- **AI** works **as a co-pilot**, **not the owner**, filling in the canvas elements quickly because each block draws on evidence gathered upstream.
- AI consolidates **prior analysis** into a canvas, but it does not design a new business model.
- **Testing entries** against what each block is meant to hold, remains a human task.
- The output works as **backup documentation**, not as a pitch.
- AI writes the canvas as analyst notes until the human sets the client's voice and vantage point.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+1	Reduces the effort of translating prior analysis into the blueprint, but not as designer of the business model or owner of the investment case.
Throughput time	+1	A complete canvas is drafted in one pass and redrafted quickly as the concept went through revisions.
Reliability	0	A standard framework with fixed blocks lets AI rerun it consistently, but it reproduces whatever the concept carries, gaps included and adds no reliability over a human.
Analytical breadth	0	Analsyses leading up to the canvas were inculcated properly into the various aspects. However, no additional dimensions to the output compared to what a human would do.
Credibility	-1	Figures are consistent with the concept assessment, but prices and volumes are presented as facts without buyer evidence, and the concept's advantage is listed rather than argued.
Usability for humans	-2	Blocks connect only loosely into a business logic, and there is no owner, ask or narrative. The output works as backup documentation, not as a blueprint for investors or leadership.

IMPLICATIONS

- The canvas belongs at the end of concept development, run once the concept is settled, as a final consistency check.
- The analyst's role moves from filling blocks to auditing block logic and the voice the canvas speaks in.
- A concept owner is still needed to turn the canvas into an investment case, and AI does not remove that role.
- The canvas can be refreshed cheaply as partner and ecosystem work changes the model.
- The client-facing canvas and the evidence behind it need to be kept as 2 separate artefacts.

LIMITATIONS

- AI states estimates with the same certainty as evidence, so assumptions read as facts.
- AI fills the sustainability blocks with plausible effects rather than a measured impact logic.
- The tone AI writes in is more representative of working notes, with internal codes, metaphors and references to earlier analysis that a client would not follow.
- Unresolved choices from earlier methods are copied across without flagging them.
- The canvas carries no persuasive narrative, so the pitch remains human work.

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

INNOVATION ACCELERATION

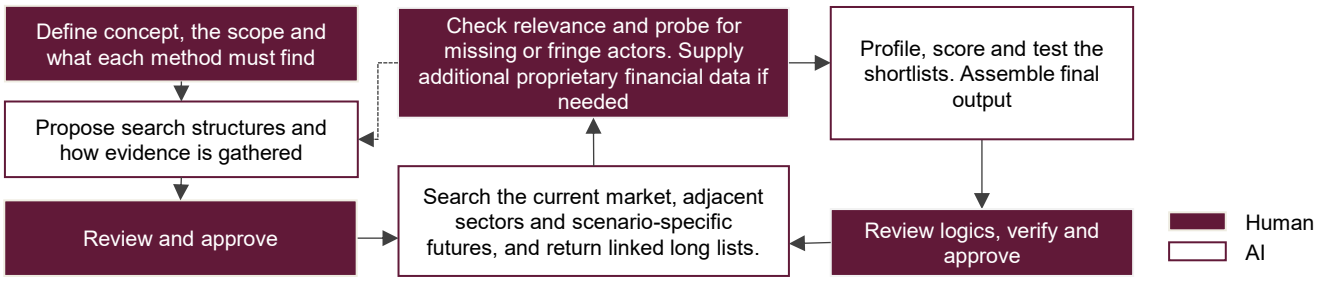
ChatGPT | Claude | OUTPUT

This AI augmented effort includes the three probing methods for **identifying innovation partner, complementors and M&A targets**. These methods find the external organisations to co-develop, complement with capabilities, or make strategic investments. AI proposed search structures, **searched and profiled at scale**, and scored candidates with linked evidence. **Human** judgment set the **search logic** for each method, supplied proprietary financial data and held the decisions.

KEY INSIGHTS

- AI works as a **4x faster scout**, covering more ground than a desk search
- The search logic decides whether AI returns partners, suppliers or competitors, so setting it stays human.
- **AI reads capability from public traces**; further intel depends on availability in fringe media.
- Key strengths included **reaching adjacent sectors** and **sensemaking patterns**.
- Credible financial data anchors AI to better results.

HUMAN OVERSIGHT IN THE LOOP



ASSESSMENT OF AI-AUGMENTED APPROACH

CRITERIA	SCORE -5 to +5	COMMENTS
Resource saving	+1	AI takes on the searching, profiling and evidence-linking. The human still designs the search, judges motive and supplies proprietary data.
Throughput time	+2	Once the search logic was agreed, 3 deep searches with profiles and shortlists ran in 2 days. Agreeing that logic took most of the human effort.
Reliability	+1	Stated criteria and evidence tags make the screens repeatable.
Analytical breadth	0	Reaches adjacent sectors, public bodies and fringe actors.
Credibility	-1	Every row links to a source. Motive, appetite, valuation and some identities rest on public inference that a human adviser would verify by contact and proprietary data.
Usability for humans	-2	Dense workbooks and summaries, with no candidate profiles, methodology report or first contacts. The output cannot go to leadership without substantial human rework.

IMPLICATIONS

- The analyst's work shifts from finding names to choosing the search logic and judging motive.
- The analyst's role shifts from finding names to designing the search logic and judging motive.
- The methods double as a test of the concept, and their findings should feed back into its economics and business model.
- Scouting can run continuously, refreshing shortlists as scenarios resolve, rather than as a one-off exercise. It becomes an in-house step run for every concept.

LIMITATIONS

- AI's long lists tilt towards organisations with strong online visibility, so quiet or early-stage actors are under-represented.
- AI identifies companies and figures with confidence from public traces, so mistaken identities surface only against filed records.
- AI treats each search as closed, so candidates found in one method are not carried to the next unless prompted.
- Without proprietary financial data, AI's price bands rest on thin proxies.

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Measured during the process

Measured upon reviewing final output

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